



Western Mindanao State University
Research Extension Services and External Linkage
RESEARCH ETHICS OVERSIGHT COMMITTEE
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WMSU REOC

SOP

MANUAL

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Western Mindanao State University
Research Extension Services and External Linkages
RESEARCH ETHICS OVERSIGHT COMMITTEE



STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURES MANUAL

INTRODUCTION

In 2013, the Research Ethics Oversight Committee (REOC) was established with the primary goal of providing exemplary research ethics reviews and practices within the academic institution. The term "oversight" was included in its acronym, as the committee was tasked with overseeing all research activities across all colleges in the institution. The SOP Manual of the REOC outlines essential components, including its inception, institutional policy on ethical review of research involving human participants, governance structure, mandate, decision-making processes, and administrative support. The REOC conducts ethical reviews for undergraduate and graduate programs, as well as externally funded research. The success of the REOC can be attributed to the dedication and hard work of the pioneering leaders and supporters of research within the institution.

To ensure that ethical standards are upheld in research involving human participants, REOC operates within the guidelines set forth by the university's institutional policy on ethical review. This policy mandates that no research projects or proposals can be implemented without first being granted ethical clearance. Additionally, all students pursuing diploma and higher education degrees must submit a thesis or dissertation output that has undergone ethical review by REOC.

The presence of REOC within the university is crucial in ensuring that research activities are conducted in a manner that protects the rights, safety, and welfare of all stakeholders. This commitment to ethical research practices is in accordance with R.A. 10532 of 2013, which established the Philippine National Health Research Systems (PNHRS) and created the Philippine Health Ethics Review Board as the national policy-making body in research ethics. The leadership of Dr. Milabel E. Ho and Dr. Jocelyn P. Pedroso, both faculty members of the College of Agriculture, was instrumental in facilitating and refining ethics review at the institution. In fact, the first SOP Manual for REOC (Version 1, 2015) was drafted and approved by the Board of Regents during their tenure.

In terms of the REOC's organizational structure, it is important to note that the committee's authority is derived from the higher governing authorities, including the Board of Regents, University President, and Vice- President of RESEL. The selection and appointment of the REOC Chair, Vice Chair, Secretariat, and other members are subject to the approval of these higher authorities. The organizational structure of the committee outlines the roles and responsibilities of its members, with the panel of reviewers being a key component in the review of undergraduate, graduate, and institutionally and externally funded research. Overall, the governance structure of the REOC is designed to ensure accountability and effective execution of the committee's mandate.

The Research Ethics Oversight Committee (REOC) at Western Mindanao State University is responsible for providing ethical review services to stakeholders. The committee follows a set of 27 standard operating procedures (SOPs), which are outlined in the manual and consist of a recommended template with ten sections. These SOPs provide a framework for the committee's decision-making processes and help ensure that ethical standards are met in all research involving human respondents. The committee members and panel of reviewers are given full authority in the conduct of review and the granting of ethical clearance to worthy stakeholders, ensuring the authenticity and integrity of their activities.

The independence of decision-making in the REOC is a crucial aspect of its functioning. The committee's offices and panel of reviewers are granted full authority in the conduct of reviews and granting ethical clearance to stakeholders. The academic institution places its trust in the authenticity and integrity of the members' decisions, whether they approve, disapprove, or continue with a project.

This autonomy allows the REOC to uphold ethical standards without outside influence, ensuring that stakeholders' interests are protected. It also reinforces the committee's accountability, as they are responsible for ensuring that all research projects meet ethical guidelines.

The REOC's independence is reflected in the organizational structure, which clearly outlines the scope of the committee's duties and responsibilities. The structure also emphasizes the committee's accountability and the importance of ethical decision-making. Ultimately, the independence of the committee supports the integrity and quality of research conducted by stakeholders.

The research conducted by the REOC is greatly facilitated by the administrative support provided by Western Mindanao State University. As a higher education institution, the university is acutely aware of the challenges faced by its constituents, including poverty and threats to peace and security, and is committed to addressing these issues through its research agenda. The university administration fully supports high-end research conducted in the region by providing a range of resources, including technological knowledge, manpower, academic expertise, and other forms of support. These efforts are instrumental in expediting the research process and helping to alleviate the ongoing pressures faced by the public, ultimately contributing to a better future for the region. By providing this support, the university demonstrates its commitment to fostering innovative research that can have a significant impact on the social and economic development of the region.

THE SOP MANUAL

The Workbook serves as a comprehensive and indispensable guide for the successful implementation of the SOP manual in the context of Research Ethics Oversight Committees (REOCs). The initial section of the Workbook provides an insightful overview of the manual, which offers an intricate description of the environment in which the REOC operates. Notably, the rationale for establishing the REOC is thoroughly expounded, with an emphasis on its relevance to the institution's vision mission. Furthermore, the Workbook recommends

the inclusion of an organogram that presents the governance structure of the institution, the location of the REOC, and its relationship with other units.

Institutional policies that focus on human protection and research ethics review are also discussed in the Workbook. Specifically, the composition, structure, and mandate of the REOC are elaborated, with a keen focus on the international and national ethics research guidelines and regulations that inform the committee's decision-making process. Additionally, the Workbook recommends the inclusion of the history of the research ethics committee, which encompasses its establishment, former chairs, and accomplishments.

Although REOCs with limited activities may opt for a simpler and straightforward listing of SOPs, the order of sequencing is subject to variation depending on the activities in question. To this end, the Workbook offers a list of recommended SOPs for REOCs, which can be used as a template for the efficient and effective implementation of research ethics oversight.

- SOP 01 – Designation of REOC Members**
- SOP 02 – Appointment of Independent Consultants**
- SOP 03 – Management of Initial Submissions**
- SOP 04 – Exempt Review**
- SOP 05 – Expedited Review**
- SOP 06 – Full Review**
- SOP 07 – Management of Resubmissions**
- SOP 08 – Review of Progress Report**
- SOP 09 – Review of Amendments**
- SOP 10 – Management of Protocol Deviation and Violations Report**
- SOP 11– Review of RNE Reports**
- SOP 12 – Management of an Application for Continuing Review**
- SOP 13 – Review of the Final Report**
- SOP 14 – Review of Early Termination Reports**
- SOP 15 – Management of Appeals**
- SOP 16 – Conduct of Site Visits**
- SOP 17 – Preparing for a Meeting**
- SOP 18 – Preparing the Meeting Agenda**
- SOP 19 – Conduct Meetings of the Panel Review**
- SOP 20 – Preparation of the Minutes of Meeting**
- SOP 21 – Communicating REOC Decisions**
- SOP 22 – Management of Incoming/Outgoing Communications**
- SOP 23 – Management of Active Files (Administrative and Study Files)**
- SOP 24 – Archiving**
- SOP 25 – Management of Access to Confidential Files**
- SOP 26 – Management of Queries/Complaints**
- SOP 27 – Writing and Revising SOPs**

To ensure consistency and clarity in the development of each SOP, it is recommended that a template consisting of a header and 10 sections be utilized. The purpose of this template is to provide guidance to the REOC throughout the process of creating each SOP, with each section containing specific questions that should be answered by the committee. In some

cases, sample answers may be provided to assist the REOC in the development process. However, it is important to note that these sample answers are not universally applicable and should be customized to fit the specific context and practices of individual committees. Any examples provided will be indicated by italicized entries and should be used as a guide when creating the SOP. It is crucial to keep in mind that not all examples will be relevant to every institution and that the REOC should adapt each SOP to fit their unique circumstances.

To provide clear identification and tracking of each SOP, a standardized header is recommended. This header should include the name and logo of the institution, the name of the REOC, the title of the SOP (corresponding to the specific activity), the assigned SOP number, the version number, and the dates of approval and effectiveness. By assigning unique SOP and version numbers, the header serves to codify each SOP and facilitate its organization and management. The suggested format for the header is as follows:

Logo of Institution	SOP TITLE	SOP No.	
		Version No.	
		Date of Effectivity	

To provide a solid foundation for the activity and procedures outlined in each SOP, **Section 1**, titled "Policy Statement," should include the institutional or committee policies upon which they are based. In addition, this section may also reference specific provisions from relevant international and national guidelines that are pertinent to the activity at hand. By including this information, the REOC can ensure that their procedures align with established policies and guidelines, promoting ethical and effective research practices.

To ensure clarity and consistency in the development of each SOP, a recommended template is utilized, consisting of a header and 10 sections. **Section 2**, titled "Objective," serves to clearly state the purpose of the activity for which the SOP is being developed. For example, in the case of an SOP titled "Preparing for a Meeting," the objective may be stated as "Preparing for a meeting aims to ensure that all meeting documents and necessary logistics are available during the meeting." By clearly stating the objective, the REOC can ensure that the SOP is tailored to achieve the specific goal of the activity in question.

Section 3 outlines the boundaries of the activity and is based on the workflow described in Section 5. It identifies the initial and final steps involved in the activity. The scope should be defined clearly to ensure that the activity remains focused and achieves its objectives. The scope may include any limitations or exclusions that are relevant to the activity. It is important to note that the scope may vary depending on the context and nature of the activity.

Section 4 of the template is dedicated to outlining the workflow involved in the activity. This may take the form of a diagram or matrix that briefly illustrates the different steps involved in the process, along with the individuals responsible for each step. The diagram may be in the form of a flowchart, utilizing standard symbols such as circles (to indicate start and end points), rectangles (to denote specific steps), and diamonds (for decision points). The person or persons responsible for each action is identified, typically using verb nouns such as "receipt of," "submission of," "conduct of," "distribution of," "filing of," and "approval of."

Section 5 of the SOP consists of a detailed description of the procedures involved in each step of the Workflow (Section 4). The procedures include the identification of responsible individuals and the specific forms that must be utilized. Active verbs are used to describe each step. It is imperative that the number of steps outlined in Section 5 is the same as the number of steps in the Workflow.

Section 6 The Forms section is a list of specific forms used in the activity, along with their corresponding codes (e.g., FR-001 Application Form)

Section 7 The history section provides a chronological record of the development of the SOP. It includes the version number, date of approval, authors, and significant changes made to the SOP. The history section serves as a reference for users of the SOP to ensure that they are using the latest version and to understand the changes made in each version. For instance, the history section of SOP Designation of REOC Members may be presented as follows:

Version Number	Date	Authors	Change/s
1	2012 June 12	ABC	Initial version
2	2014 December 10	DEF	Added the determination of type of review as a responsibility of the member secretary
3	2018 December 5	GHI	Included a co-chair as a member.

	DESIGNATION OF RESEARCH ETHICS OVERSIGHT COMMITTEE (REOC) MEMBERS	SOP No.	1
		Version	7
		Date of Effectivity	24-Mar-2025

1. Statement of Policy

The Research Ethics Oversight Committee (REOC) shall have a Chair, Vice-Chair, REOC Secretary, Ethics Review Panel (ERP) Chairs and members, and two (2) REOC staff. The Chair, Vice Chair, REOC Secretary, ERP members except for the non-scientist and non-affiliated must be regular faculty of the University who shall be recommended by the Vice President for RESEL and designated by the University President. They must have attended at least the Basic Training for Ethics Protocol Review. The non-scientist members may be Visiting Lecturers or Office Clerks of the University with a bachelor's degree and have attended Basic Ethics Training. The non-affiliated members may come from other institutions and have attended at least Basic Ethics Training. The two (2) REOC staff may be hired as Contract of Service (COS) or Job Order (JO).

2. Objective of the activity

The Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) on the Selection and Appointment of REOC Members aims to ensure that the composition of the REOC complies with international, national and institutional guidelines that emphasize and account for the relevant expertise and appropriate representation of members across disciplines and sectors. Moreover, the same SOP identifies the constitution of the REOC to include the non-scientists and non-affiliated members.

3. Scope

This Standard Operating Procedure applies only to the designation of REOC members (i.e., REOC Chair, Vice Chair, REOC Secretary, ERP chairs and members, non-scientist and non-affiliated members). This SOP starts with the recommendation of the REOC members and ends with filing of the pertinent documents.

4. Workflow

The procedure involved in the selection of REOC members varies in different institutions. Some by direct appointment of the authorities and others elect the members during a special committee meeting. In the latter case, the workflow will be as follows:

For the selection and appointment of the REOC Chair

Step No.	Activity	Responsible Person
1	Recommendation	REOC Chair
2	Receipt of Special Order	REOC Chair
3	Forwarding of Appointment papers to the new members	REOC Staff
4	Confidentiality Agreement and Conflict of Interest Disclosure	REOC Chair
5	Office Assumption	
6	Filing of appointment documents and CVs in the membership file (SOP 23 on Management of Active Files)	REOC Staff

For the selection and appointment of the other REOC members

Step No.	Activity	Responsible Person
1	Recommendation	REOC Chair
2	Concurrence	REOC Chair
3	Receipt of Special Order	REOC member
4	Forwarding of Appointment papers to the new members	REOC Staff
5	Confidentiality Agreement and Conflict of Interest Disclosure	REOC member
6	Office Assumption	
7	Filing of appointment documents and CVs in the membership file (SOP 23 on Management of Active Files)	REOC Staff

5. Description of Procedures

As provided in the workflow presented above, the following steps are described.

5.1 Selection and appointment of the WMSU REOC Chair

Step 1 – Recommendation. The REOC Chair will be recommended by the Vice President for RESEL to the University President.

Step 2 – Receipt of Special Order. Upon the approval of the President, a special order will be issued to the designated REOC chair. The special order enumerates the designee's roles and responsibilities, including release time and other benefits, if applicable

Step 3 – Forwarding of Appointment papers to the new REOC Chair. Within 2 days, the REOC staff shall forward the Appointment (Special Order) to the newly designated REOC Chair.

Step 4 – Confidentiality agreement and conflict of interest disclosure. Before assuming office, the REOC Chair is required to sign a confidentiality agreement and conflict of interest disclosure.

Step 5 – Office Assumption. The designated REOC Chair, upon receipt of the Special Order, assumes office and shall perform the duties and responsibilities stipulated in the Special Order.

Step 6 – Filing of pertinent documents. The REOC staff files the appointment documents and comprehensive curriculum vitae.

5.2. For the selection and appointment of the other REOC members

Step 1 – Recommendation. The designated REOC Chair submits recommendations to the Vice President for Research, Extension Service and External Linkages (VP-RESEL).

Step 2 – Concurrence. Upon favorable consideration, the recommendation of the new REOC members will be concurred by the Vice President for Research, Extension Services and External Linkages.

Step 3 – Receipt of Special Order. In consideration of the merit of the recommendation provided by the REOC Chair with the concurrence of the VP-RESEL, the President of the University issues a special order designating the identified person to serve as REOC members (i.e., Vice Chair, REOC Secretary, ERP chairs and members, including non-scientist and non-affiliated). The special order enumerates the designee's roles and responsibilities, including release time and other benefits, if applicable.

Step 4 – Forwarding of Appointment papers to the new REOC member. Within 2 days, the REOC staff shall forward the Appointment (Special Order) to the newly designated REOC member.

Step 5 – Signing of pertinent documents. Upon assuming office, the REOC member is required to sign a conflict of interest, disclosure, and confidentiality agreement.

Step 6 – Office Assumption. The designated REOC member, upon receipt of the Special Order, assumes office and shall perform the duties and responsibilities stipulated in the Special Order.

Step 7 – Filing of pertinent documents. The REOC staff files appointment document and comprehensive curriculum vitae.

6. Forms

FR-001 – Curriculum Vitae Template

FR- 003 – Confidentiality Agreement and Conflict of Interest Disclosure

7. History of the Standard Operating Procedure

Version No.	Date	Authors	Main Change
1	March 2015	Dr. Jocelyn P. Pedros Prof. Carmen T. Ramos Prof. Melinda May V. Mas Ms. Jovelyn I. Legaspi	First Draft
2	January 16, 2017	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	Duties and Functions of the ff: 1. The Scientific but Non affiliated Member 2. The Lay Member
3	June 1, 2021	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	There were changes in the following: - Statement of Policy - Scope - Roles and Responsibility - Organizational Structure Composition of WMSU-REOC Ethics Review Panel (ERP)
4	February 16, 2022	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	Specified the minimum number of members in the CERP, Including the nonaffiliated and lay members. Specified that the Secretariat is composed of Member Secretary, Staff secretary, and clerk. Included that one of the duties of the Member Secretary is to supervise the staff secretary and clerk.
5	July 26, 2022	Prof. Herne B. Esguerra	WMSU-REOC Organizational Chart
6	February 3, 2023	Dr. Ericson O. Alieto	Workflow and Description of Procedures
7	August 2, 2023	Dr. Analyn D. Saavedra	<i>Changed REOC officer to REOC member, Glossary and References</i>

 	APPOINTMENT OF INDEPENDENT CONSULTANTS	SOP No.	2
		Version	6
		Date of Effectivity	24-Mar-2025

1. Statement of Policy

The REOC shall invite an independent consultant whose expertise is not represented in the current membership but is needed in a study under review. He/she need not be affiliated with the institution.

2. Objective of the Activity

This activity aims to ensure that the appointment of independent consultants conforms with institutional practice and complements the pool of expertise in the REOC.

3. Scope

This SOP specifically pertains to the selection and designation of independent consultants in the review of research protocols of the REOC. This SOP begins with the identification of the study that requires an independent consultant and ends with the inclusion of the name of the Independent Consultant in the pool of consultants.

4. Workflow

Below are the different activities involved in the conduct of an Appointment of Independent Consultants and the responsible person/s in each of the activity.

Step No.	Activity	Responsible Person
1	Identification of the study that requires an independent consultant	REOC Chair/REOC Vice Chair
2	Identification of The Independent Consultant	REOC Chair, REOC Vice Chair
3	Invitation to the Independent Consultant	REOC Chair
4	Receipt of the Signed Invitation, Confidentiality Agreement and Conflict of Interest Disclosure	REOC Staff
5	Receipt of the Appointment of Independent Consultant	REOC Staff
6	Inclusion in the Pool of Independent Consultants	REOC Staff

5. Description of Procedures

Step 1 - Identification of the study that requires an independent consultant: Either the REOC Chair or REOC Vice Chair identifies the study that requires an expertise necessary in the review of a research protocol and that may not be provided by the current members of the REOC.

Step 2 - Identification of the independent consultant: The REOC Chair or REOC Vice Chair refers to the roster of specialists in the institution or in other institutions for the necessary expertise and selects the appropriate expert. S/he instructs the REOC staff to prepare the letter of invitation.

Step 3 - Invitation of the independent consultant: The REOC Staff prepares a LET-009 – letter of invitation containing the Terms of Reference for signature of the Chair and sends this to the identified expert. The letter of invitation contains a section for acceptance of the invitation (conforme) and FR-003 – Form for conflict of disclosure and confidentiality agreement.

Step 4 - Receipt of the signed invitation, confidentiality agreement and conflict interest disclosure: The staff receives the signed invitation, Confidentiality and Conflict of Interest Disclosure agreement and files this in the appropriate folder.

Step 5 - Appointment of independent consultant: Upon receipt of the acceptance of the invitation, the REOC Staff prepares a memorandum addressed to the WMSU President requesting for appointment of independent consultant (LET-009). The request for appointment shall be recommended by the VP-RESEL for approval by the WMSU President and release of appointment.

Step 6 - Receipt of the appointment of independent consultant: Upon receipt of appointment from the Office of the WMSU President, a copy of the appointment shall be provided to the independent consultant.

Step 7 - Inclusion in the pool of independent consultant: The REOC Staff enters the name of the new independent consultants in the appropriate database containing name, expertise, institution and date of appointment.

6. Forms

FR-003 – Confidentiality Agreement Conflict and of Interest Disclosure
LET-009 – Letter of Invitation

7. History of the Standard Operating Procedure

Version No.	Date	Authors	Main Change
1	March 2015	Prof. Melinda May V. Mas	First Draft
2	January 16, 2017	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	No Changes
3	June 1, 2021	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	No Changes
4	February 16, 2022	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	<i>Replaced ERP to REOC/CERP Included COI declaration in the description of procedures.</i>
5	February 03, 2023	Dr. Reynante E. Autida	Workflow and Description of Procedures
6	August 2, 2023	Dr. Analyn D. Saavedra	<i>Glossary and References</i>

	MANAGEMENT OF INITIAL SUBMISSIONS	SOP No.	3
		Version	6
		Date of Effectivity	24-Mar-2025

1. Statement of Policy

The WMSU REOC shall require submission of a set of relevant documents for an application for ethical review. Applications for ethical review may be submitted through several modes (e.g. hand-carried by the researcher, through email or through the use of an online-platform provided). Only complete submission of documents is accepted for ethical review. A preliminary evaluation shall determine whether a research protocol is exempted from or needs to undergo ethical review based on the NEGRIHP 2022.

2. Objective of the activity

The Management of initial submissions ensures that relevant documents submitted are complete, properly documented, and properly evaluated to substantiate appropriate action or type of review.

3. Scope

The REOC staff shall accept the research protocol submitted by the faculty and students for initial review. This SOP begins with the receipt of study documents for initial review and ends with entry of protocol information in the database.

4. Workflow

Below are the different activities involved in the conduct of Management of Initial Submission and the responsible person/s in each of the activity.

Step No.	Activity	Responsible Person
1	Receipt of study documents for initial review and determination of completeness of submission.	REOC Staff
2	Entry into the logbook	
3	Coding of documents	
4	Determination of type of Action/ Type of Review A. Exemption (SOP4) B. Expedited (SOP 5) C. Full Review (SOP 6)	REOC Chair/ Vice Chair

5	Preparation of a protocol folder	REOC Staff
6	Entry into the database	

5. Description of Procedures

Step 1 – Receipt of research protocols for initial review and determination of the completeness of submission: The REOC staff receives the relevant application documents for initial review of protocol and determination of completeness of documents. Acceptance of application for ethics review will be from 8:00 AM to 5:00 PM with noon break. An Application Form FR-002 attached to every application document shall be used by the REOC staff to determine completeness of the submitted documents. In the event that the documents submitted are incomplete, the REOC staff shall return the protocol package.

Step 2 – Entry into logbook: Details of all received an application for ethics review documents shall be logged into the WMSU REOC logbook by the REOC staff. Details shall include the (1) specific date and time of receipt, (2) title of the study, (3) name of the proponent, (4) date of submission, (5) name of the receiver and (6) action. Likewise, the name and signature of the individual who actually submitted the documents in case s/he is not the proponent shall also be included.

Step 3 – Coding of documents: Each study with complete documents for review received by the REOC staff shall be assigned with a code. The code includes information on the year of submission and a series number. The series number will refer to the order of submission when that specific protocol was received (e.g. If Ms. Juana DeLa Cruz submitted a protocol in 2023 and it was the 2nd protocol submitted for the year, then it will bear the code 2023-02). Further, the code shall also serve as the ID number of the protocol and cannot be assigned to any other protocol. When referring to the protocol in communications or presentations, the code shall be used.

Step 4 - Determination of type of Review/Action: The WMSU- REOC Chair/Vice Chair conducts a preliminary review of the protocol to determine whether it will undergo Expedited, Full or be Exempted from Review. If the protocol qualifies for the exemption, the REOC Chair/Vice Chair directs the REOC staff to follow SOP on Exemption. However, if the REOC Chair/Vice Chair determines that the protocol should undergo either Full or Expedited review, then the REOC staff proceeds to follow either SOP 04 on Expedited Review or SOP 05 Full Review.

Step 5 - Preparation of a Protocol Folder: The REOC staff files the protocol documents in a protocol folder and labels it accordingly. (SOP 23 Managing Active Files)

Step 6 – Entry into the database: The REOC staff shall update the database as described in SOP 23 on Managing Active Files.

6. Forms

FR-002 – Application Form
FR-004 – Study Protocol Assessment Form
FR-005 – Informed Consent Assessment Form
FR-007 – Exempt Review Form
Logbook

7. History of the Standard Operating Procedure

Version No.	Date	Authors	Main Change
1	March 2015	Ms. Jervil F. Omaga Mr. Ryan Joseph M. Dela Torre Ms. Rubelle Marshah H. Alavar Ms. Jovelyn I. Legaspi	First Draft
2	January 16, 2017	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	The Study protocol or related communications received by the REOC Secretariat are sorted and recorded in the Submission Log.
3	June 1, 2021	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	No changes
4	February 16, 2022	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy Ms. Jovelyn I. Legaspi	Replaced ethics review panel members with primary reviewers Specified WMSUREOC Coding System
5	February 3, 2023	Dr. Dulce Amor P. Matondo	Workflow and Description of Procedures
6	August 2, 2023	Dr. Analyn D. Saavedra	<i>Glossary and References</i>

 	EXEMPT FROM REVIEW OF A RESEARCH PROTOCOL	SOP No.	4
		Version	6
		Date of Effectivity	24-Mar-2025

1. Statement of Policy

Exempt from Review is the term used to denote that a protocol does not need to undergo full or expedited review after an initial review conducted by the REOC Chair/Vice Chair. The following are the characteristics of the protocols which shall be exempted from the review (adapted from National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants (NEGRIHP 2022))

- a. Protocols with no human participants or do not involve more than minimal risks or harms;
- b. Protocols for institutional quality assurance purposes, evaluation of public service programs, public health surveillance, educational evaluation activities and consumer acceptability tests;
- c. Research that only includes interactions involving survey procedures, interview procedures, or observation of public behaviour (including visual or auditory recording), if the following criteria are met:
 - c. 1. There will be no disclosure of the human participants' responses outside the research that could reasonably place the participants at risk of criminal or civil liability or be damaging to their financial standing, employability or reputation and;
 - c. 2. The investigator records the information obtained in such a manner that the identity of the human participants cannot readily be ascertained directly or through identifiers linked to the participants.
- d. Protocols that involve the use of publicly available data or information.

2. Objective of the activity

This Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) serves as a guide for a consistent process of exempting protocols from review, specifically those involving no human participants or non-vulnerable populations with minimal or low risk for harm.

3. Scope

This SOP shall apply to all study protocols which do not entail more than minimal risk to study participants, whose participants do not belong to vulnerable groups, and where vulnerability issues do not arise. This SOP starts with the evaluation of the research protocol using the assessment for exemption from review and ends with the inclusion of the review in the agenda of the next meeting.

4. Workflow

Below are the different activities involved in the conduct of an expedited review and the responsible person/s in each of the activity.

Step No.	Activity	Responsible Person
1	Evaluation of the protocol using the assessment for exempt review	REOC Chair/ Vice Chair
2	Issuance of certificate of exemption from ethics review	REOC Chair
3	Communicates the Result to the Researcher/s	REOC Staff
4	Filing of documents in the protocol file SOP 23 on Management of Active Files	REOC Staff
5	Inclusion of the result to the list of protocols under exempted from review in the Agenda of the next meeting SOP 18 on Preparing the Meeting Agenda	REOC Chair & REOC Secretary

5. Description of Procedures

Step 1 – Evaluation of the protocol using the assessment on Exempt from review. Within 5 days from the acceptance of complete documents, the REOC Chair/ Vice Chair shall evaluate the protocol using FR-006 – Exempt Review Assessment Form on the Protocols Exempted from Review.

Step 2 – Issuance of certificate of exemption from ethics review. Protocols with no human participants or do not involve more than minimal risks or harms or those that have the characteristics of the protocols which shall be exempted from the review as discussed from National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants (NEGRIHP 2022) shall be issued a certificate of exemption from Ethics Review. This shall be issued within 3 days after the evaluation of the protocol.

Step 3 – Communicates the Result to the Researcher/s. Within 2 days after the issuance of the certificate of exemption from the ethics review, the result and certificate will be communicated/forwarded to the researcher/s.

Step 4 – Filing of documents in the protocol file SOP 23 on Management of Active Files. The REOC staff classifies the documents as an active file. Active files shall be kept in a secured cabinet, arranged in an orderly manner that shall allow easy identification and retrieval SOP 23 on Management of Active Files.

Step 5 – Inclusion of the result to the list of protocols under exempted from review in the Agenda of the next meeting SOP 18 on Preparing the Meeting Agenda. The REOC secretary prepares the draft report on research protocols that are exempted from review in the agenda for the next REOC regular meeting. The REOC chair reviews and approves the draft report SOP 18 on Preparing the Meeting Agenda.

6. Forms

FR-006 Exempt Review Assessment Form
FR-003 – Confidentiality Agreement and Conflict of Interest Disclosure
CERT.001- Certificate of Exemption
LTR-006- Approval - Approval Letter

7. History of the Standard Operating Procedure

Version No.	Date	Authors	Main Changes
1	March 2015	Dr. Julieta B. Tendero	First Draft
2	January 16, 2017	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	No Changes
3	June 1, 2021	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	No changes
4	February 16, 2022	Ms. Narhuda H. Unga CERPChair/REOC member	Created an exempt review evaluation form REOC/CERP Chair will decide on whether the protocol is for Exempt, Expedited, or Full review. Arranged the step-by-step procedures accordingly
5	March 13, 2023	Dr. Analyn D. Saavedra	Inclusion of Protocols under exempted review and procedure
6	August 2, 2023	Dr. Analyn D. Saavedra	<i>Glossary and References</i>

	EXPEDITED REVIEW	SOP No.	5
		Version	6
		Date of Effectivity	24-Mar-2025

1. Statement of Policy

All study protocols that do not entail more than minimal risk to the study participants, do not have study participants belonging to a vulnerable group, and the study procedures do not generate vulnerability shall undergo expedited review. The expedited review shall involve two (2) Primary Reviewers. The results of the initial review must be released to the researcher within ten (10) working days upon receipt of a complete set of documents. The study protocol that underwent expedited review and approved shall be reported in the subsequent regular committee meeting.

2. Objective of the activity

Expedited Review aims to demonstrate reasonable steps that meet the expectations and standards of protecting human participants in the conduct of a study.

3. Scope

This SOP starts with the assignment of reviewers and ends with the inclusion of the review in the agenda of the next meeting.

4. Workflow

Below are the different activities involved in the conduct of an Expedited Review and the responsible person/s in each of the activity.

Step No.	Activity	Responsible Person
1	Assignment of Reviewers	REOC Chair/REOC Vice Chair
2	Notification and Provision of study protocol and evaluation forms to reviewers	REOC Staff
3	Accomplishment of review and submission of evaluation forms	Primary Reviewers
4	Consolidation, finalization, and recommendation of review findings and decision.	Panel Secretary

5	Communication of review findings and decision to the researcher (SOP 21 on Communicating REOC Decisions)	REOC Staff
6	Filing of documents in the protocol file (SOP 23 on Management of Active Files)	REOC Staff
7	Inclusion of the Review in the Agenda of the next meeting (SOP 18 on Preparing the Meeting Agenda)	REOC Secretary

5. Description of Procedures

Step 1 – Assignment of Reviewers. The REOC Chair/REOC Vice Chair assigns a research protocol to the 2 primary reviewers.

Step 2 – Notification and Provision of study protocol and evaluation forms to reviewers. Once the complete set of research protocol is submitted to the REOC staff, the REOC Chair/REOC Vice Chair will assign the protocol to the ERP where only two (2) primary reviewers will be assigned to review the research protocol. Then, the REOC staff notifies and provides each Primary Reviewer a copy of the research protocol and the evaluation forms within 3 working days. Prompt notification provides an opportunity to assess conflict of interest, availability, suitability of reviewers, and the need for independent consultant/s.

Step 3 – Accomplishment of review and Submission of Evaluation forms. The assigned Primary Reviewers are given ten (10) working days upon receipt of a complete set of protocol and evaluation forms to accomplish the review.

Step 4 – Consolidation, finalization, and recommendation of review findings and decision. The Panel secretary consolidates and reports in writing the review findings and decision of each member and submits it to the ERP Chair three (3) working days after the review session. In case of differing opinions between the 2 primary reviewers, The ERP Chair finalizes the review results and decision and will have the final say. The ERP chair submits review findings and decisions to the REOC chair. The decision including clear instructions/recommendations for guidance of the researcher must be written on a notification letter (LTR-005) signed by the REOC chair. Should the study protocol merit an approval without any revisions, an ethical clearance certificate (CERT-001) signed by the REOC Chair will be issued to the researcher.

Step 5 – Communication of review findings and decision to the researcher. The REOC staff prepares and issues (e.g., email or hand-delivered or pick up at the REOC office) the notification letter or the ethical clearance certificate to the researcher within 2 working days after the ERP chair submits review findings and decision to the REOC chair.

The REOC Chair shall require re-submission of a protocol with minor or major revision/s not later than 15 working days after receipt of the notification letter. The notification letter includes the decision points (Approved, Minor Modifications/revisions, Major Modifications/revisions, and Disapproved) and submission of other relevant pertinent/documents required by the primary reviewers. Re-submission of expedited reviewed research protocol still shall undergo expedited review regardless of the required revisions. Failure to comply with the re-submission timeline constitutes re-application. Issuance of ethics clearance is deferred until the recommendation for modification has been complied (see SOP 21 on Communicating REOC Decisions).

Step 6 - Filing of documents in the protocol file. The REOC staff classifies the document as an active file. Active files shall be kept in a secured cabinet, arranged in an orderly manner that shall allow easy identification and retrieval updating on the database. (see SOP 23 on Management of Active Files).

Step 7 - Inclusion of the Review in the Agenda of the next REOC regular meeting. The REOC secretary prepares the draft report on research protocols that underwent expedited review in the agenda for the next REOC regular meeting. The REOC chair reviews and approves the draft report (see SOP 18 on Preparing the Meeting Agenda).

6. Forms

FR-004-Study Protocol Assessment Form
FR-005-Informed Consent Assessment Form
FR-003-Confidentiality Agreement and Conflict of Interest Disclosure
FR-016-Meeting Agenda
CERT.001-Certificate of Exemption

7. History of the Standard Operating Procedure

Version No.	Date	Authors	Main Change
1	March 2015	Dr. Jocelyn P. Pedroso Prof. Carmen T. Ramos	First Draft
2	January 16, 2017	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	<i>Deleted from Statement of Policy of SOP 11-Expedited Review - pp. 42</i>

3	June 1, 2021	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	No changes
4	February 16, 2022	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy Ms. Jovelyn I. Legaspi	Included in the Policy Statement: <i>Protocols approved initially under expedited review shall undergo resubmissions and post-approval submissions.</i> Replaced panel with primary reviewers Specified that the ethical clearance will be signed by the REOC CHAIR. Added in the flowchart and detailed procedure: <i>the decision in the meeting agenda</i>
5	February 3, 2023	Dr. Rica Rose May A. Rubio	Workflow and Description of Procedures
6	August 2, 2023	Dr. Analyn D. Saavedra	<i>Scope, Description of Procedures Step 5, Glossary and References</i>

	FULL REVIEW	SOP No.	6
		Version	6
		Date of Effectivity	24-Mar-2025

1. Statement of Policy

A full review shall be conducted for research protocols with more than minimal risk to the participants, particularly if they are members of a vulnerable group, or when a study generates vulnerability to the participants. Full review shall be conducted through a primary reviewer system. If necessary, independent consultants and the proponents shall be invited during the meeting to clarify certain issues before a documented communication is finalized. The decision shall be communicated to the proponent within four (4) weeks after submission of the required documents to include post approval reports (eg. amendments).

2. Objective of the activity

A full review seeks to ensure compliance with technical and ethical standards in the conduct of research involving human participants and identifiable human data and materials.

3. Scope

This SOP applies to initial, re-submissions and post-approval submissions which are classified as entailing more than minimal risk to study participants or whose participants belong to vulnerable groups. This SOP begins with the assignment of ERP or independent consultant/s (if needed) and ends with the filing of protocol-related documents.

4. Workflow

Below are the steps and activities involved in the conduct of a full review and the responsible person/s in each of the activities.

Step No.	Activity	Responsible Person
1	Assignment of ERP and independent consultants if needed.	REOC Chair/REOC Vice Chair
2	Provision (Hard copy or electronic) of research protocol-related documents and assessment forms to the assigned ERP.	REOC staff

3	Presentation of review findings and recommendations during a Committee meeting SOP 19 on Conduct of Meeting	ERP Chair
4	Conduct of meetings (expand) consolidation and finalization and recommendation of review findings and decision	REOC Chair and ERP
5	Summary of issues and resolutions (Ethical and scientific issues)	REOC Chair
6	Committee action	REOC members and Chair
7	Documentation of Committee deliberation and action SOP 9 on Preparing the Meeting Minutes.	REOC Secretary
8	Communication of Committee Action to the researcher SOP 9 on Communicating REOC Decisions	REOC Staff
9	Filing of protocol-related documents and Updating of the Protocol Database	REOC Staff

5. Description of Procedures

Step 1 – Assignment and Notification of ERP and Independent Consultants (if needed). The assignment of primary reviewers for the full review will be done by the REOC Chair. The assignment will be based on the alignment of the research protocols with the expertise of the primary reviewers and guarantees that each protocol is assessed by appropriate reviewers who are knowledgeable of the protocol topic at hand. Each panel will also have a Panel Secretary with review functions and a non-scientist member who will review the Informed Consent Process and Form. For post approval reports, the same ERP shall be assigned to review the reports.

Step 2 – Provision of protocol and protocol-related documents and assessment forms to ERP and independent consultants (if needed). Upon confirmation/acceptance, the REOC staff prepares copies of the protocol and/or protocol-related documents, as well as assessment forms, for delivery to the ERP and/or independent consultants.

Step 3 – Presentation of review findings and recommendations during a committee meeting. The primary reviewers submit their findings and recommendations to the chair three days after the review (FR-005 Protocol evaluation worksheet and FR-006 ICF evaluation worksheet). The Panel Chair presents the findings and recommendations during the meeting. If a

primary reviewer is unable to attend the meeting, the Chair has the authority to assume the role of the primary reviewer so that the meeting can proceed.

Prevailing issues and risks which are beyond the control of the primary reviewers need to be presented during the special or regular meeting. The presentations will be sequenced based on the assessment form items evaluated.

Step 4 – Discussion of technical and ethical issues. The chair leads the discussion of technical and ethical issues using the processed FR-004–Study Protocol Assessment Form and the FR-005–Informed Consent Assessment Form and the assessment of the primary reviewers as guides for an orderly exchange of ideas.

Step 5 – Summary of issues and resolutions (ethical and technical issues). The Chair summarizes the technical and ethical issues that were identified, the issues that were resolved / not resolved, and the recommendations for the unresolved issues which will be included in the minutes of meeting.

Step 6 – Committee action. The ERP members shall vote for approval, minor modifications, major modifications, disapproval, and the majority decision is followed. Otherwise, the ERP may also opt by consensus, so as long as there is a strong objection, the deliberation continues until the strong objector is persuaded.

Step 7 – Documentation of committee deliberation and action. Deliberation on the decision points of the ERP will be documented following the formatting on SOP 17 on Preparing the Meeting Minutes.

Step 8 – Communication of Committee Action to the researcher. Documented information will be communicated using the SOP 21 on Communicating REOC Decisions

Step 9 – Filing of protocol-related documents and Updating of the Protocol Database. Filing is also according to SOP 23 on Managing Active Files.

6. Forms

FR-004 – Study Protocol Assessment Form
FR-005 – Informed Consent Assessment Form
LET-005 – Approval letter

7. History of the Standard Operating Procedure

<i>Version No.</i>	<i>Date</i>	<i>Authors</i>	<i>Main Change</i>
1	March 2015	Dr. Socorro Rebecca Felonia Prof. Eulyn H. Tangalin Dr. Jocelyn P. Pedroso	First Draft
2	January 16, 2017	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	No Changes
3	June 1, 2021	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	No Changes
4	February16, 2021	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	No Changes
5	February 3, 2023	Ms. Erelee Q. Salang	<i>Workflow and Description of Procedures</i>
6	August 2, 2023	Dr. Analyn D. Saavedra	<i>Glossary and References</i>

 	MANAGEMENT OF RESUBMISSIONS	SOP No.	7
		Version	6
		Date of Effectivity	24-Mar-2025

1. Statement of Policy

The REOC staff shall require a resubmission of a protocol that needs either minor or major modification/s not later than 4 weeks after receipt of the Decision Letter. The initial determination on the type of review will be the basis for the type of review on the resubmitted research protocols.

2. Objective of the activity

Management of resubmissions ensures that the researcher complied with the required modifications before approval of the research protocol.

3. Scope

This SOP refers to the resubmission of revised or modified protocols that have been previously reviewed by the REOC Chair/REOC Vice Chair. The procedure begins with the receipt of the revised protocol documents and ends with filing of the documents in the protocol file and the entry of the submission in the protocol database.

4. Workflow

Below are the steps and activities involved in management of resubmission and the responsible person/s in each of the activities.

Step No.	Activity	Responsible Person
1	Receipt and Entry in the Logbook	REOC Staff
2	Retrieval of the original protocol and labelling of resubmitted documents with the original code	
3	Notification of the Assigned ERP	
4	Review of the Re-submission a. Expedited Review (SOP 5 on Expedited Review) b. Full Review (SOP 6 on Full Review)	ERP
5	Communication of Decision	REOC Staff
6	Filing of Documents in the Protocol File and Update of the database	

5. Description of Procedures

Step 1 – Receipt and Entry in the Logbook. Receipts of resubmitted protocol or modified protocol/ICF, FR-007 - resubmission application forms and other pertinent documents and entry in the logbook shall be done by the REOC Staff. The REOC Staff checks the new version number of the protocol/ICF and if the modifications are highlighted.

Step 2 – Retrieval of the original protocol and labelling of resubmitted documents with the original code. The REOC Staff shall retrieve the original protocol and label the resubmitted protocol with the code assigned to the protocol when it was initially submitted and the date of receipt on all the documents.

Step 3 – Notification of the Assigned ERP. The REOC Staff retrieves the LET-008 –Decision Letter relating to the original protocol. Provided with the necessary information, the REOC Staff informs the assigned ERP concerned and forward to them the required documents.

Step 4 – Review of the Re-submission. The assigned ERP shall conduct review of the resubmitted protocol by referring to the resubmission form and taking notes of the different recommendations on the first review and evaluate whether these were acceptably addressed in the resubmitted protocol. Expedited protocols shall be reviewed within 10 days while protocol that needs full review shall be given 15 days. The Panel Secretary submits the report to the REOC Chair for inclusion in the next regular meeting.

Step 5 – Communication of Decision. For re-submission that went on full review, the REOC staff shall communicate its decisions to the researcher/s within 2 days after the receipt of the complete set of submission documents. The documents shall include the decision points, clear instructions and recommendations for guidance of the researcher which is signed by the ERP Chair.

Step 6 – Filing of Documents in the Protocol Folder and update of the database. The REOC Staff gathers all the pertinent documents related to the re-submission (revised protocol, assessment forms, excerpts of minutes, approval letter) files them in the corresponding protocol folder and enters it in the protocol database.

6. Forms

FR-007 – Resubmission Form
LET-006 – Approval Letter

7. History of the Standard Operating Procedure

Version No.	Date	Authors	Main Change
1	March 2015	Ms. Jervil F. Omega Mr. Ryan Joseph M. Dela Torre Ms. Rubelle Marshah H. Alavar Ms. Jovelyn I. Legaspi	First Draft
2	January 16, 2017	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	The Study protocol or related communications received by the REOC Secretariat are sorted and recorded in the Submission Log.
3	June 1, 2021	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	No changes
4	February 16, 2022	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy Ms. Jovelyn I. Legaspi	Replaced ethics review panel members with primary reviewers Specified WMSUREOC Coding System
5			Deleted: <i>The Primary Reviewers meet to decide who will be the Panel Chair, Secretary and Panel Member and agree on the time when to meet for the initial ethics review deliberation of findings.</i>
6	August 2, 2023	Dr. Analyn D. Saavedra	<i>Glossary and References</i>

	REVIEW OF PROGRESS REPORT	SOP No.	8
		Version	6
		Date of Effectivity	24-Mar-2025

1. Statement of Policy

The REOC shall require the submission of progress reports at a frequency based on the level of risk of the study. This requirement shall be explicitly stated in the Approval Letter.

2. Objective of the activity

The SOP reviews and updates the progress report of the research to ensure that the conduct of the study is in compliance with the approved protocol which observes the protection of the welfare and dignity of human participants as well as the integrity of the data.

3. Scope

This SOP begins with the receipt and entry to logbook of incoming documents and the protocol database and ends with filing of progress report and committee decision in the protocol file.

4. Workflow

Below are the different steps involved in the Review of Progress Report and the responsible person/s in each of the activity.

Step No.	Activity	Responsible Person
1	Receipt and entry into logbook of the progress report (SOP 23 on Management of Active Files)	REOC Staff
2	Retrieval of Pertinent Protocol & Forwarding of the Progress Report to the Ethics Review Panel	REOC Staff
3	Review/Evaluate the submitted Progress Report	ERP
4	Communication of Findings to the Researcher/s	REOC Staff
5	Filing of Progress Report and Decision letter and updating on the protocol database.	REOC Staff

5. Description of Procedures

Step 1 – Receipt and entry to logbook. The REOC Staff receives the Progress Report Form and enters the date and pertinent information in the logbook of incoming documents (See SOP 23 on Management of Active files).

Step 2 – Retrieval of Pertinent Protocol & Forwarding of the Progress Report to the Ethics Review Panel. The REOC staff retrieves the corresponding protocol file for the reference and guidance of the ERP. Within two (2) days after receipt of the progress report, the REOC Staff notifies and sends the Progress Report to the ERP.

Step 3 – Review/Evaluation of the Submitted Progress Report. Within five (5) days after the receipt of the progress report from the REOC staff, the ERP will review/evaluate the progress report following the approved protocol using the FR-009-Application for Ethics Review of Progress Report. If there are things/situations that did not adhere to the approved protocol, this should be justified by the researcher/s using the same form.

Step 4 – Communication of the Findings to the Researcher/s. Within two (2) days upon receipt of the Findings FR-009-Application for Ethics Review of Progress Report from the ERP, it will be forwarded to the Researcher/s. The REOC staff shall prepare a draft of the ERP's decision based on either an expedited report or minutes of a meeting. The ERP Chair signs the decision letter as follows: Approval, request for additional information or specific action/s.

Step 5 – Filing of Progress Report and Updating on the Protocol Database. The Staff files the progress report and proceeds to update the pertinent protocol database.

6. Forms

FR-009-Application for Ethics Review of Progress Report
Logbook
Database

7. History of the Standard Operating Procedure

Version No.	Date	Authors	Main Change
1	March 2015	Dr. Jocelyn P. Pedroso	First Draft
2	January 16, 2017	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	No changes
3	June 1, 2021	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	No changes
4	February 16, 2022	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy Ms. Jovelyn I. Legaspi	Harmonized the flowchart with the detailed procedures, and replaced panel reviewers to primary reviewers.
5	February 5, 2023	Dr. Analyn D. Saavedra	Flowchart and Description of Procedures
6	August 2, 2023	Dr. Analyn D. Saavedra	<i>Glossary and References</i>

	REVIEW OF AMENDMENTS	SOP No.	9
		Version	8
		Date of Effectivity	24-Mar-2025

1. Statement of Policy

The REOC shall require the submission of proposed amendments for review and approval before their implementation. This requirement shall be explicitly stated in the LET-005 – Approval Letter.

2. Objective of the activity

The Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) on the Review of Amendment aims to ensure that the conduct of the study is in compliance with the approved protocol such that any change such as amendments does not impact safety and welfare of study participants.

3. Scope

This SOP applies to the management and review of protocol amendments submitted by the proponent while the study is on-going. This SOP begins with the receipt and entry of the submission of amendment in the logbook of incoming documents then protocol database, and finally with the filing of the amendments and committee decision in the protocol file.

4. Workflow

Below are the different steps involved in the Review of Amendments and the responsible person/s in each of the activity.

Step No.	Activity	Responsible Person
1	Receipt and entry into logbook the application for Review of Amendments (SOP 23 on Management of Active Files)	REOC Staff
2	Retrieval of Pertinent Protocol & Forwarding of the Amendments Forms to the Ethics Review Panel	REOC Staff
3	Review/Evaluate the submitted Amendments Forms	ERP
4	Communication of Findings to the Researcher/s	REOC Staff
5	Filing of Amendments Forms and Decision letter and updating on the protocol database.	REOC Staff

5. Description of Procedures

Step 1 – Receipt and entry to logbook. The REOC Staff receives the Progress Report Form and enters the date and pertinent information in the logbook of incoming documents SOP 23 on Management of Active files.

Step 2 – Retrieval of Pertinent Protocol & Forwarding of the Amendments Forms to the Ethics Review Panel. The staff retrieves the corresponding protocol file for the reference and guidance of the ERP. Within two (2) days after receipt of the *Amendments Forms*, the REOC Staff notifies and sends the *Amendments Forms* to the ERP.

Step 3 – Review/Evaluation of the Submitted *Review of Amendment Form*. Within five (5) days after the receipt of the Amendments Forms from the REOC staff, the ERP will review/evaluate the Amendments Forms following the approved protocol using the FR-008 – Review of Amendment Form. If there are things/situations that did not adhere to the approved protocol, this should be justified by the researcher/s using the same form. The ERP will decide on the Classification of Amendments into: **minor**, which may undergo expedited review do not entail more than minimal risk to the participants, do not have participants belonging to a vulnerable group or study procedures do not generate vulnerability to the participants, (see SOP 5 on Expedited Review) and **major** which shall undergo full review entail more than minimal risk to the participants, participants are members of a vulnerable group, or study procedures generate vulnerability to the participants (see SOP 6 on Full Review).

Step 4 – Communication of the Findings to the Researcher/s. Within two (2) days upon receipt of the Findings LET-005 Approval Letter from the ERP, it will be forwarded to the Researcher/s. The ERP Chair signs the decision letter as follows: Approval, request for additional information or specific action/s.

Step 5 – Filing of *Review of Amendment Form* and Updating on the Protocol Database

The Staff files the FR-008 – Review of Amendment Form and proceeds to update the pertinent protocol database.

6. Forms

FR-008 – Review of Amendment Form
LET-005 Approval Letter
Logbook
Database

7. History of the Standard Operating Procedure

Version No.	Date	Authors	Main Change
1	March 2015	Dr. Jocelyn P. Pedroso	First Draft
2	January 16, 2017	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	No changes
3	June 1, 2021	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	No changes
4	February 16, 2022	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy Ms. Jovelyn I. Legaspi	Included in the Statement of Policy: Only those protocols that have been previously approved but now have revisions can be subjected to amendments. Replaced ethics review panel to primary reviewers.
5	February 3, 2023	Dr. Marvin A. Maulion	Flowchart and Description of Procedures
6	August 2, 2023	Dr. Analyn D. Saavedra	<i>Glossary and References</i>
7	September 24, 2024	Dr. Analyn D. Saavedra Dr. Rica Rose May A. Rubio	Additional statement on criteria enumerated for classifying amendments into: minor OR major amendments
8	March 18, 2025	Dr. Analyn D. Saavedra	Descriptions and Steps

 	MANAGEMENT OF PROTOCOL DEVIATION AND VIOLATION REPORT	SOP No.	10
		Version	3
		Date of Effectivity	24-Mar-2025

1. Statement of Policy

Protocol deviations and violations impact safety and welfare of the research participants and integrity of data. Researchers shall report protocol deviations and violations in the conduct of approved research within a week from the detection of the protocol violation/deviation. Major protocol violations will undergo full review.

2. Objective of the activity

Review of protocol deviations and violations aims to ensure that the safety and welfare of human participants in the study are safeguarded and that the credibility and integrity of data are maintained.

3. Scope

This SOP applies to the review of reports of protocol deviations or violations in the conduct of previously approved studies. This begins with the receipt and documentation of the report of protocol violations and deviations in the logbook and ends with the filing of all related documents and update of the database.

4. Workflow

Below are the different steps involved in the management of protocol violations and deviations and the responsible person/s in each of the activity.

Step No.	Activity	Responsible Person
1	Receipt of report of protocol violations and deviations FR-018 – Violation and Deviation Form and documentation of report in the logbook/database	REOC Staff
2	Retrieval of pertinent protocol file	REOC Staff
3	Notification and Forwarding of the Protocol deviations and violations to the assigned ERP	REOC Staff
4	Review/Evaluation of the submitted Protocol deviations and violations	Assigned ERP

5	Inclusion of report in the agenda of the next REOC regular meeting.	REOC Chair and REOC Secretary
6	Communication of decision to the researcher (SOP 21 on Communicating REOC Decisions).	REOC Staff
7	Filing of all related documents and update of the protocol database (SOP 23 on Managing Active Files).	REOC Staff

5. Description of Procedures

Step 1 – Receipt of report of FR-018–Protocol Violations and Deviations Form and documentation of report in the logbook/database. The REOC staff receives the report on protocol deviation or violation in the appropriate report form FR-018 and records this in the logbook/database.

Step 2 – Retrieval of pertinent protocol file. The REOC staff retrieves the approved protocol for reference and guidance of the assigned ERP.

Step 3 – Notification and Forwarding of the Protocol deviations and violations to the assigned ERP. Within two working (2) days, the REOC staff notifies and sends the protocol deviation or violation report and together with the retrieved pertinent documents to the assigned ERP.

Step 4 – Review/Evaluation of the submitted Protocol deviations and violations. Within 7 working days, the assigned ERP will review/evaluate the submitted protocol deviations and violations.

Step 5 – Inclusion of report in the agenda of the next REOC regular meeting. The REOC Chair and REOC secretary include the report on protocol deviation and violation in the agenda of the next meeting (see SOP 18 on Preparing the Meeting Agenda; SOP 19 on Conduct of Meeting).

Step 6 – Communication of decision to the researcher. The REOC secretary prepares the decision based on the report submitted by the Panel Secretary. Possible decisions include one or several of the following: (1) submission of additional information, (2) submission of corrective action, (3) invitation to a clarificatory interview, (4) Requirement for an amendment (5) site visit, (6) suspension of recruitment, and (7) withdrawal of ethical clearance. The REOC staff issues (e.g., email or hand-delivered or pick up at the REOC office) the notification letter of the decision to the researcher within 3 working days after the review.

Step 7 – Filing of all related documents and update of the protocol database. The REOC staff collates and files the retrieved protocol documents, the report on protocol deviation and violation and the decision

letter in the appropriate protocol file and updates the protocol database with the relevant information (see SOP 23 on Managing Active Files).

6. Forms

FR-018–Protocol Violations and Deviations Form
Logbook/database
Notification Letter

7. History of the Standard Operating Procedure

Version No.	Date	Authors	Main Change
1	March 2015	Dr. Jocelyn P. Pedroso	First Draft
2	February 3, 2023	Dr. Rica Rose May A. Rubio	Workflow and Description of Procedures
3	August 2, 2023	Dr. Analyn D.Saavedra	<i>Glossary and References</i>

 	REVIEW OF REPORTABLE NEGATIVE EVENTS (RNE) REPORTS	SOP No.	11
		Version	3
		Date of Effectivity	24-Mar-2025

1. Statement of Policy

The REOC shall require the submission of Reportable Negative Events (RNE) reports, at the latest three (3) days after the event has come to the attention of the researcher/s. A special meeting shall be considered depending on the level of risk involved.

2. Objective of the activity

Review of RNE reports aims to ensure that the safety and welfare of human participants and the research team are safeguarded and that information on RNEs are properly documented and evaluated.

3. Scope

This SOP applies to the review of RNE reports. This SOP begins with the receipt and documentation of submission of RNE report in the logbook and ends with the filing of all related documents and update of the protocol database.

4. Workflow

Below are the different steps involved in the Review of Reportable Negative Events (RNE) Reports and the responsible person/s in each of the activity.

Step No.	Activity	Responsible Person
1	Receipt and documentation of submission of RNE report in the logbook.	REOC Staff
2	Retrieval of the Pertinent Protocol File	REOC Staff
3	Notification and forwarding of the RNE report to the ERP	REOC Staff
4	Call for a Special Meeting	REOC Chair
5	Deliberation on the RNE	REOC Chair and ERP
6	Communication of REOC action to the researcher/s and	REOC staff

	to the institutional authority	
7	Filing of all related documents (SOP 23 on Management of Active Files) and Update of the protocol database	REOC Staff

5. Description of Procedures

Step 1 – Receipt and documentation of submission of RNE report in the logbook. The REOC Staff receives the accomplished FR-011-Reportable Negative Event (RNE) Form and enters the submission into the logbook. The Staff notes whether the submission is within the required timeline.

Step 2 – Retrieval of the Pertinent Protocol File. The staff retrieves the approved protocol file and checks the identity of the primary reviewers. The Staff notifies and sends the report to the ERP who may decide to call for a special meeting.

Step 3 – Notification and forwarding of the RNE report to the ERP. The staff notifies and sends the report and the retrieved documents to the assigned ERP.

Step 4 – Call for a Special Meeting. The REOC Chair may call for a special meeting (SOP 18). The researcher/s and the other team may be invited for a clarificatory meeting.

Step 5 – Deliberation on the RNE. The REOC Chair leads the discussion of the special meeting, summarizes the RNE report and informs the ERP regarding the presence of the research team for clarificatory meeting. The safety issues are evaluated, i.e., identification of risks to the participants/research team, nature and effectiveness of preliminary interventions with or without the help of community constituents/authority, impact on integrity of data and completion of the research. The REOC Chair and ERP deliberate on possible options, as follows:

- recommend suspension of the study until risk is resolved.
- withdrawal of ethical clearance
- submission of a plan to mitigate risk/harm
- require an amendment to the protocol
- uphold original ethical clearance

Step 6 – Communication of REOC action to the researcher/s and to the institutional authority. Within 2 days, the REOC staff communicates the decision letter SOP 21 to the researcher/s.

Step 7 – Filing of all related documents and update of the protocol database. The REOC Staff files all related documents and updates the protocol database.

6. Forms

FR-011-Reportable Negative Event (RNE) Form

7. History of the Standard Operating Procedure

<i>Version No.</i>	<i>Date</i>	<i>Authors</i>	<i>Main Change</i>
1	March 2015	Dr. Jocelyn P. Pedroso	First Draft
2	February 3, 2023	Dr. Analyn D. Saavedra	Workflow and Description of Procedures
3	August 2, 2023	Dr. Analyn D. Saavedra	<i>Glossary and References</i>

 	MANAGEMENT OF AN APPLICATION FOR CONTINUING REVIEW	SOP No.	12
		Version	3
		Date of Effectivity	24-Mar-2025

1. Statement of Policy

The REOC shall require the submission of an application for Continuing Review at least 6 weeks before the expiration of the ethical clearance of a protocol. Protocols that underwent Full review in its initial submission shall undergo Full review in its application for Continuing Review. Similarly, protocols that underwent expedited review shall undergo the same type of review in its application for Continuing Review.

2. Objective of the activity

This SOP is created to ensure that the study is compliant to the approved protocol that the safety and welfare of the participants are maintained, and that protection of data integrity is demonstrated from the initial release of the ethical clearance towards the end of the study.

3. Scope

This SOP applies to on-going studies with ethical clearance that are about to expire. It manages applications for Continuing review that begins with the receipt of an application for continuing review and ends with the entry to logbook and protocol database.

4. Workflow

Below are the different activities involved in the process of review of Continuing Review and the responsible person/s in each of the activity.

Step No.	Activity	Responsible Person
1	Receipt of the application for Continuing Review and entry to logbook	REOC Staff
2	Retrieval of pertinent protocol files	REOC Staff
3	Notification of the Assigned ERP	REOC Staff
4	Communication of committee action	REOC Chair and REOC Staff
5	Filing of documents in the appropriate protocol folder and Update of the protocol Database	REOC Staff

5. Description of Procedures

Step 1 – Receipt of the application for Continuing Review and entry to logbook. The REOC Staff receives, logs and enters in the protocol database the information included in the application for Continuing review FR-012 – Application for Continuing Review Form.

Step 2 – Retrieval of pertinent protocol files. The REOC Staff retrieves the approved protocol and prepares a summary of the progress reports, protocol deviation/violation reports, SAE/SUSAR reports, report of negative events (RNEs) and corresponding decisions including the type of initial review during the period of effectivity of the ethical clearance for implementation.

Step 3 – Notification of the Assigned ERP. The REOC staff notifies the assigned ERP thru SMS, email or online communication apps regarding the request within 5 days prior to the expiration of the ethical clearance of a protocol. With attached summary of the reports submitted and decisions made during the period of effectivity of the ethical clearance for implementation. The assigned ERP will also be informed on the type of review of the protocol.

Step 4 – Communication of committee action. The REOC Secretary prepares the draft decision based on the report of the expedited review or the minutes of the meeting in the full review. The ERP Chair finalizes and signs the decision letter. Possible decisions include the following: Approval, Additional information required, submission of an explanation for failure to submit required reports or disapproval.

Step 5 – Filing of documents in the appropriate protocol folder and Update of the protocol Database. REOC staff files the application for Continuing review, the recommendations of the reviewers and decision letter in the appropriate protocol folder.

6. Forms

FR-024 Application for Continuing Review Form
Logbook
Database

7. History of the Standard Operating Procedure

Version No.	Date	Authors	Main Change
1	February 16, 2022	Ms. Narhuda H. Unga	First Draft
2	February 3, 2023	Ms. Erelee Q. Salang	Workflow and Description of Procedures
3	August 2, 2023	Dr. Analyn D. Saavedra	Glossary and References

 	REVIEW OF FINAL REPORT	SOP No.	13
		Version	6
		Date of Effectivity	24-Mar-2025

1. Statement of Policy

The REOC shall require the submission of the final report not later than 2 weeks after the end of the study. Final reports shall undergo either expedited or full review.

2. Objective of the Activity

This SOP aims to evaluate if the study was in compliance with the approved protocol and that the safety and welfare of study participants were promoted and the integrity of data protected until the end of the study.

3. Scope

This SOP applies to the management and review of final reports submitted by researcher/s at the end of the study. This SOP begins with the receipt and entry of the final report into the logbook and ends with an update on the protocol database.

4. Workflow

Below are the different activities involved in the process of review of Review of Final Report and the responsible person/s in each of the activity.

Step No.	Activity	Responsible Person
1	Receipt of final report and entry into logbook (SOP 23 on Management of Active Files)	REOC Staff
2	Retrieval of pertinent protocol file	REOC Staff
3	Notification of ERP	REOC Staff
4	Review of the Final Report	ERP
5	Communication of committee action (SOP 21 on Communication REOC Decisions)	REOC Chair and REOC Staff
6	Filing of the Final Report and related documents and update of the protocol files.	REOC Staff

5. Description of Procedures

Step 1 – Receipt and entry of final report into logbook. The REOC Staff receives and enters the date of receipt of the final report into the logbook.

Step 2 – Retrieval of pertinent protocol file. The REOC staff retrieves the corresponding protocol file, FR-015 Final Report Form (for coding) as reference in the review of the Final Report.

Step 3 – Notification of ERP. The REOC staff notifies the ERP of the receipt of the Final Report and awaits further instructions.

Step 4 – Review of the Final Report. The assigned ERP reviews the submitted final report of the researcher/s and submits the result to the REOC Chair. The REOC Chair instructs the REOC staff to include the report in the agenda of the next meeting and to ensure that the ERP is given the necessary documents so that s/he can prepare the presentation during the next meeting (SOP 05 on Full Review).

Step 5 – Communication of committee action (SOP 21 on Communicating REOC Decisions): It is suggested that the REOC consider the following decisions in the review of a final report: acceptance of the Final Report or to require resubmission with corrections.

Step 6 – Filing of the Final Report and related documents and update of the protocol database. The REOC Staff files the Final Report and related documents in the appropriate folder and updates the protocol database.

6. Forms

FR-015- Final Report Form
Logbook
Database

7. History of the Standard Operating Procedure

Version No.	Date	Authors	Main Change
1	March 2015	Dr. Jocelyn P. Pedroso	First Draft
2	January 16, 2017	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	No changes
3	June 1, 2021	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	No changes
4	February 16, 2022	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy Ms. Jovelyn I. Legaspi	Included in the statement of policy that all protocols reviewed by REOC EREB/ERP should submit a final report, including exempt from the review so that it can be archived.
5	February 5, 2023	Dr. Analyn D. Saavedra	Flowchart and Description of Procedures
6	August 2, 2023	Dr. Analyn D. Saavedra	Glossary and References

 	REVIEW OF AN EARLY TERMINATION REPORT	SOP No.	14
		Version	6
		Date of Effectivity	24-Mar-2025

1. Statement of Policy

When a decision for early termination of the research has been made, the well-being and safety of study participants that have already been recruited shall be the primary consideration and the plan for termination shall reflect this concern. Early termination reports shall undergo full review. The criteria for early termination are as follows: poor recruitment, lack of funding, inability of the researcher to continue the study, and the participants and/or the study team may be at high risk of harm that cannot be mitigated.

2. Objective of the activity

Review of early termination reports aims to ensure that the decision takes into consideration the safety and welfare of the study participants that have already been recruited and that there is adherence to the principle of fairness for all concerned.

3. Scope

The SOP applies to the review of early termination reports. This SOP begins with the receipt and entry to the logbook of the early termination reports and ends with the communication of committee action to the researcher/investigator and updating of the protocol database.

4. Workflow

Below are the different activities involved in the process of Review of an Early Termination Report and the responsible person/s in each of the activity.

Step No.	Activity	Responsible Person
1	Receipt of the early termination report and entry into the logbook	REOC Staff
2	Retrieval of pertinent protocol file	REOC Staff
3	Notification of the assigned ERP	REOC Staff

4	Review of the Early Termination Reports	ERP
5	Communication of committee action	REOC Chair and REOC Staff
6	Updating of the protocol database	REOC Staff

5. Description of Procedures

Step 1 – Receipt and entry to the logbook and database. The REOC Staff receives the early termination report and enters the appropriate information in the logbook.

Step 2 – Retrieval of pertinent protocol file. The REOC Staff retrieves the protocol folder and summarizes the documents that have been submitted.

Step 3 – Notification of Assigned ERP. The REOC Staff informs the REOC Chair and the ERP by email about the report and the summary of documents that have been submitted and waits for further instructions.

Step 4 – Review of the Early Termination Reports. The ERP conduct review of the documents submitted and prepares a presentation for the next meeting. The review should ensure implication of the early termination on the rights, safety, and welfare of the study participants, in the form of a termination package with a set of procedures. The procedures may include adapting specific provisions for continued access to protective mechanisms and information by the study participants.

Step 5 – Communication of committee action. The REOC Secretary prepares a draft of the committee decision. The REOC Chair signs the decision letter considering the following possible decisions in the review of an early termination report: acceptance of the decision with no further action; request for additional information; or requirement for further action.

Step 6 – Update of the Protocol Database. The REOC Staff updates the protocol database.

6. Forms

FR-014 – Early Termination Form
LET-008 – Decision Letter
Logbook
Database

7. History of the Standard Operating Procedure

Version No.	Date	Authors	Main Change
1	March 2015	Dr. Jocelyn P. Pedroso	First Draft
2	January 16, 2017	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	No changes
3	June 01, 2021	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	No changes
4	February 16, 2022	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy Ms. Jovelyn I. Legaspi	Included in the statement of policy that all protocols reviewed by REOC EREB/ERP should submit a final report, including exempt from the review so that it can be archived.
5	February 5, 2023	Asso. Prof. Marvin A. Maulion	Workflow and Description of Procedures
6	August 2, 2023	Dr. Analyn D. Saavedra	<i>Glossary and References</i>

	MANAGEMENT OF APPEALS	SOP No.	15
		Version	3
		Date of Effectivity	24-Mar-2025

1. Statement of Policy

The REOC shall consider the perspective of the researcher regarding the feasibility and acceptability of REOC recommendations including its disapproval. Appeals from researchers shall undergo full review and shall be resolved within 15 working days upon receipt of the fully documented appeal.

2. Objective of the activity

Management of appeals ensures fairness, transparency and comprehensiveness of ethics review that takes into consideration the perspective of the researcher.

3. Scope

The SOP on Management of Appeals covers procedures that begin with the receipt of the appeal and ends with filing of documents and updating of the protocol database.

4. Workflow

Below are the different activities involved in the process of review of Management of Appeals and the responsible person/s in each of the activity.

Step No.	Activity	Responsible Person
1	Receipt of an appeal	REOC Staff
2	Retrieval of pertinent protocol file	REOC Staff
3	Notification of REOC Chair and concerned ERP	REOC Staff
4	Inclusion in Agenda of the next regular meeting	REOC Chair and REOC Secretary
5	Discussion of and deliberation on the appeal	REOC Chair, ERP and Independent Consultant (if needed)

6	Communication of committee action SOP 21 on Communicating REOC Decisions	REOC Chair
7	Filing of documents and updating of the protocol database	REOC Staff

5. Description of Procedures

Step 1 – Receipt of an Appeal. The REOC staff receives the letter of appeal and enters the pertinent information into the logbook.

Step 2 – Retrieval of pertinent protocol file. The REOC staff retrieves the pertinent file for reference in the review. The file includes the initially submitted protocol, ICF, research tools and other related documents.

Step 3 – Notification of REOC Chair and concerned ERP. The REOC staff notifies the REOC Chair and concerned ERP about the letter of appeal and awaits further instructions.

Step 4 – Inclusion in the Agenda of the next regular meeting. The REOC Chair instructs the REOC Secretary to include the appeal in the agenda of the next meeting, to ensure that the retrieved protocol and related documents are available during the meeting and to inform the researcher to be available on the scheduled meeting in case there is a need for further clarification.

Step 5 – Discussion of and Deliberation on the Appeal. The ERP Chair summarizes the protocol and the previous discussion of the issues in the protocol as background to the appeal. The REOC Chair presents the contents of the appeal and leads discussion. The researcher may be called in for further clarification of issues. The researcher is asked to step out after the committee has taken up the issues for clarification. The committee then decides (by consensus) whether to accept any or all of the points raised in the appeal. The presence of independent consultant may be requested if their expertise is needed.

Step 6 – Communication of Committee Action. Based on the deliberations, the REOC Chair summarizes the decision points and instructs the REOC Secretary to prepare the draft LET-009 - Decision Letter for his/her finalization and forwarding to the researcher. (SOP 21 on Communicating REOC Decisions)

Step 7 – Filing of Documents and Update of Protocol Database. The REOC staff files all the documents into the appropriate folder and updates the protocol database accordingly.

6. Forms

LET-008-Decision Letter
Logbook
Database

7. History of the Standard Operating Procedure

<i>Version No.</i>	<i>Date</i>	<i>Authors</i>	<i>Main Change</i>
1	February 16, 2022	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy Ms. Narhuda H. Unga	First Draft
2	February 3, 2023	Dr. Reynante E. Autida	Workflow and Description of Procedures
3	August 2, 2023	Dr. Analyn D. Saavedra	<i>Glossary and References</i>

 	CONDUCT OF SITE VISITS	SOP No.	16
		Version	6
		Date of Effectivity	24-Mar-2025

1. Statement of Policy

The REOC shall conduct visits of selected sites of approved protocols that fall within the following established criteria for such visits: (a) high risk studies, (b) receipt of significant number of protocol violations, (c) receipt of complaints from participants and families, (d) non-receipt of required after-approval reports from the and (e) multiple studies conducted by a researcher.

2. Objective of the activity

Site visits are mechanisms with which the REOC monitors compliance with approved protocols, ICF process and continuing protection and promotion of participant's dignity, rights, and well-being.

3. Scope

This SOP includes the steps in conducting visits to study sites for reasons set by the REOC. It begins with the selection of the site to be visited and ends with filing of Site-Visit Reports in the protocol folder and updating of the protocol database.

4. Workflow

Below are the different activities involved in the process of Conduct of Site Visits and the responsible person/s in each of the activity.

Step No.	Activity	Responsible Person
1	Selection of site to visit	REOC Chair and Panel Chair
2	Notification of researcher	REOC Staff
3	Creation of Site Visit Team	REOC Chair
4	Conduct of site visit	Site Visit Team (members)
5	Preparation of Draft Report and Presentation During the Regular Meeting	Site Visit Team (members)
6	Transmittal of Final Report and Recommendations to the Researcher/s	REOC Chair and Staff
7	Filing of Site-Visit Reports in the protocol folder and update of Protocol database	REOC Staff

5. Description of Procedures

Step 1 – Selection of site to visit. The REOC Chair shall decide which research site to visit upon the recommendation of the ERP Chair. The following are the criteria for selecting the site to be visited: high risk studies, consistent non-submission or failure to submit after-approval submission requirements, reports of major protocol noncompliance, significant number of serious adverse events, and reports of complaints from study participants. If at least one of the criteria is demonstrated, site visit must be conducted. However, the committee then decides (by consensus) during a regular meeting whether to visit the site or not, and the logistics of the visit in case the visit shall proceed.

Step 2 – Notification of researcher. The researcher shall be informed through a letter about the site visit at least two weeks before the scheduled visit. The letter shall be forwarded to the investigator by the REOC staff and shall contain the visit details and documents to be prepared (reports, etc.).

Step 3 – Creation of Site Visit Team. The REOC Chair shall create the Site Visit team composed of two members from the assigned ERP. The Site Visit team shall be provided with the copy of the research document under evaluation ahead of time together with the FR- 016-Site Visit Report Form.

Step 4 – Conduct of Site Visit. The FR- 016-Site Visit Report Form shall be accomplished by the ERP representative, approved by the Panel Chair and conformed by the researcher.

The points to cover during the site visit include:

- Study protocol version
- Informed consent documents: verify if the site is using the most recently approved version
- Post-approval documents: verify if these have been submitted to and approved by the REOC.
- Security, privacy, and confidentiality of the documents at the study site
- Facilities in the study site
- Determination of the protection of the rights, safety, and welfare of human participants in the study

Step 5 – Preparation of Draft Report and Presentation During the Regular Meeting. The Site Visit Report Form shall be accomplished during the site visit. The presentation of the findings of the site visit shall be included in the agenda of the next REOC meeting and shall be presented by the ERP Chair. The committee then decides (by consensus) the determination of action.

Step 6 – Transmittal of Final Report and Recommendations to the Researcher/s. The REOC staff prepares a summary of the findings and recommendations of the REOC based on the deliberations during the

meeting. The REOC Chair finalizes the draft for transmittal to the Researcher.
(SOP 21 on Communicating REOC Decisions)

Step 7 – Filing of Site-Visit Reports in the protocol folder and update of Protocol database. The staff files the Site Visit Report and the recommendations in the appropriate folder and updates the protocol database accordingly. (SOP 23 on Management of Active Files)

6. Forms

FR-016 - Site Visit Report Form

7. History of the Standard Operating Procedure

Version No.	Date	Authors	Main Change
1	March 2015	Prof. Antonietta H. Domen Prof. Norqueen Dumadaug Ms. Rubelle Marshah H. Alavar	First Draft
2	January 16, 2017	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	No changes
3	June 1, 2021	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	No changes
4	February 16, 2022	Dr. Iana Rene. Estandian	Specified the reasons for a site visit in the Statement of Policy Included the debriefing the site researcher of the findings and the researcher should given a report of the site visit.
5	February 3, 2023	Dr. Reynante A. Autida	Workflow and Description of Procedures
6	August 2, 2023	Dr. Analyn D. Saavedra	Glossary and References

 	PREPARING FOR A MEETING	SOP No.	17
		Version	6
		Date of Effectivity	24-Mar-2025

1. Statement of Policy

The REOC shall have a regular schedule of meetings every Wednesday of the week. All meetings shall be held within the premises of the institution. Special meetings shall be held to resolve issues that require immediate attention, e.g. safety of participants, protocol violation that impact research integrity. Virtual meetings or teleconferences via ZOOM shall be considered when face-to-face meetings are not possible.

2. Objective of the activity

Preparing for a meeting SOP aims to establish a well-coordinated, organized, and efficient conduct of meetings.

3. Scope

This SOP commences with the preparation of the meeting agenda and ends with the notification of REOC members and confirmation of their attendance.

4. Workflow

Below are the different activities involved in the process of Preparing for a Meeting and the responsible person/s in each of the activity.

Step No.	Activity	Responsible Person
1	Preparation of the Meeting Agenda (SOP 18) for the Regular Meeting	REOC Secretary
2	Preparation of the Venue and Physical Arrangement	REOC Staff
3	Preparation of documents and other materials needed for the meeting	REOC Staff
4	Notification of REOC Members and confirmation of attendance	REOC Secretary and REOC Staff

5. Description of Procedures

Step 1 – Preparation of the agenda: The REOC Secretary will prepare the provisional agenda and inform each member on the items to be included.

Step 2 – Preparation of the Venue and Physical Arrangement. The REOC staff makes reservations with concerned units/divisions in the university about the upcoming meeting of the REOC (date, time, appropriate conference room, and adequate food and drinks/water) one week before the schedule.

Step 3 – Preparation of documents and other materials needed for the meeting. The REOC staff gathers the documents and materials for the meeting based on the provisional agenda, e.g. copies of the provisional agenda, provisional minutes of the previous meeting, protocols and related documents submitted, at least 10 days before the meeting, post-approval reports, expedited review reports, administrative memos, etc.

Step 4 – Notification of REOC Members and confirmation of attendance. The REOC secretary supervises the REOC staff in the preparation of the Notice of Meeting that includes the provisional agenda. The REOC staff sends the notice of meeting to the members of the committee thru SMS, email and all available communication platforms, at least, one week before the schedule and follows-up the confirmation of attendance to ensure quorum. In case quorum cannot be met, the REOC staff informs the REOC Chair and the REOC secretary so that alternate members may be called in.

6. Forms

FR-016 –Meeting Agenda

7. History of the Standard Operating Procedure

Version No.	Date	Authors	Main Change
1	March 2015	Mrs. Norqueen T. Dumadaug Prof. Antonietta H. Domen	First Draft
2	January 16, 2017	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	No changes
3	June 1, 2021	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	No changes
4	February 16, 2022	Mr. Jerry Paul L. Caitum	<i>Changes in the Statement of Policy, Purpose, Scope, Flowchart, and Description of Procedure</i>
5	February 3, 2023	Prof. Swidin S. Husin	<i>Workflow and Description of Procedures</i>
6	August 2, 2023	Dr. Analyn D. Saavedra	<i>Glossary and References</i>

	PREPARATION OF THE MEETING AGENDA	SOP No.	18
		Version	6
		Date of Effectivity	24-Mar-2025

1. Statement of Policy

The meeting agenda shall be based on the submissions received, at the latest, 10 days before the scheduled regular meeting. It shall follow an established template for meeting agenda. The provisional agenda shall be included in the Notice of Meeting.

2. Objective of the activity

The preparation of the meeting agenda aims to ensure a smooth, orderly, inclusive, and efficient conduct of meetings.

3. Scope

This SOP describes how the REOC determines what items are to be included in the agenda of regular and special meetings. This SOP begins with the preparation of the draft meeting agenda and ends with the filing of the final meeting agenda.

4. Workflow

Below are the different activities involved in the process of Preparing the Meeting Agenda and the responsible person/s in each of the activity.

Step No.	Activity	Responsible Person
1	Preparation of the draft meeting agenda	REOC Secretary
2	Preparation of the provisional meeting agenda	REOC Chair & Secretary
3	Distribution of the provisional meeting agenda, SOP 17 on Preparing for a Meeting	REOC Staff
4	Approval of the provisional meeting agenda	REOC Members
5	Filing of the final meeting agenda, SOP 23 on Management of Active Files	REOC Staff

5. Description of Procedures

Step 1 – Preparation of the draft meeting agenda. The REOC Secretary prepares the draft agenda two (2) weeks before the scheduled meeting, using the FR-016 – Meeting Agenda. The agenda includes the following:

1. Call to Order
2. Declaration of Quorum
3. Approval of the Provisional Agenda
4. Disclosure of Conflict of Interest
5. Review and Approval of the Minutes of the Previous Meeting
6. Business Arising from the Minutes
7. New Business:
 - 7.1. Initial Review of Protocols
 - 7.2. Review of Resubmissions
 - 7.3. Review of After Approval Submissions
 - 7.4. Report on Expedited Review of Protocols
 - 7.5. Report on Expedited Review of After-Approval Submissions
 - 7.6. Report of Site Visits
8. Other Matters

Step 2 – Preparation of the provisional meeting agenda: The REOC Chair reviews and approves the draft agenda (within 2 days) as the basis of preparing the provisional agenda for inclusion in the Notice of Meeting.

Step 3 – Distribution of the provisional meeting agenda: The provisional agenda is included in the Notice of Meeting SOP 17 on Preparing for a Meeting.

Step 4 – Approval of the provisional meeting agenda: The REOC members approve the provisional agenda during the meeting SOP 19 Conduct of Meeting.

Step 5 – Filing of the final meeting agenda: The REOC staff files the final (approved) meeting agenda in a special folder that contains all meeting agenda in a chronological order SOP 23 on Managing Active Files.

6. Forms

FR-016 – Meeting Agenda

7. History of the Standard Operating Procedure

<i>Version No.</i>	<i>Date</i>	<i>Authors</i>	<i>Main Change</i>
1	March 2015	Mrs. Norqueen T. Dumadaug Prof. Antonietta H. Domen	First Draft
2	January 16, 2017	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	No changes
3	June 1, 2021	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	No changes
4	February 16, 2022	Jerry Paul L. Caitum	<i>Changes in the Statement of Policy, Purpose, Scope, Flowchart, and Description of Procedure</i>
5	February 3, 2023	Prof. Swidin S. Husin	Workflow and Description of Procedures
6	August 2, 2023	Dr. Analyn D. Saavedra	<i>Glossary and References</i>

	CONDUCT MEETINGS OF THE PANEL REVIEW	SOP No.	19
		Version	6
		Date of Effectivity	23-Oct-2023

1. Statement of Policy

There shall be two types of REOC meetings, namely: the regular and the special meeting. The regular Panel Review meeting will be held once a month for each Panel Reviewer. Meetings will be presided by the Panel Review Chair. The meeting will proceed only after a quorum is attained and will be guided by the approved agenda. This will be attended with at least five (5) members including the presence of non-scientist and non-affiliated member.

To avoid compromised judgment, actions or decisions due to personal interest, conflict of interest among the members shall be disclosed before the discussion of agenda items.

2. Objective of the activity

Meetings are conducted to provide an opportunity for the REOC to arrive at collegial decisions regarding the study protocols and REC operations and to be informed of pertinent administrative and operations-related matters.

3. Scope

This SOP describes the manner by which the REOC conducts all its meetings. It covers REOC actions and activities from the time the meeting is called to order and quorum is declared to the time the meeting is adjourned. This SOP begins with the distribution of meeting materials and ends with the adjournment.

4. Workflow

Below are the different activities involved in the process of Conduct of Meetings and the responsible person/s in each of the activity.

Step No.	Activity	Responsible Person
1	Distribution of meeting materials	REOC Staff
2	Declaration of quorum (formal start)	Panel Chair
3	Approval of the provisional agenda	Panel Reviewers

4	Declaration of conflict of Interest (COI)	Panel Reviewers
5	Approval of minutes of the previous meeting	Panel Reviewers
6	Discussion of “Business arising from the minutes”	Panel Reviewers
7	Review of protocols and protocol-related submissions (SOP 6 on Full Review)	Primary Reviewers/Panel Chair/Panel Members
8	Report of results of expedited review (SOP 5 on Expedited Review)	Designated Primary Reviewers
9	Report of protocols Exempted from review	Panel Chair
10	Discussion of operations-related matters	Panel Chair/Panel members
11	Adjournment	REOC Chair

5. Description of Procedures

Step 1 – Distribution of meeting materials. The REOC staff distributes meeting materials such as the provisional agenda, minutes of the previous meeting at least five (5) days before the meeting.

Step 2 – Declaration of quorum. The Panel Chair, the presider, calls the meeting to order, declares the presence of a quorum. Quorum is declared when at least five (5) of all members are in attendance. However, the declaration of quorum requires the presence of one non-scientist and one non-affiliated member.

Step 3 – Approval of the provisional agenda. The provisional agenda will be presented by the Panel Secretary. The Panel Chair invites the members to examine the provisional agenda and to propose addition or deletion of items. The agenda items are approved by a simple majority vote.

Step 4 – Declaration of Conflict of Interest. The Panel Chair will ask the Panel members to declare if they have any Conflict of Interest after the approval of the agenda. Members with Conflict of Interest (COI) will inhibit themselves from participating in the discussion and decision-making of the protocol during the meeting.

4.1 – Management of conflict of interest: Before the conduct of the meeting, the REOC members who are involved in one of the studies that will be discussed will be asked to excuse himself to avoid conflict of interest. After the discussion of his/her protocol, he/she will be requested to participate in the other remaining agenda.

Step 5 – Approval of minutes of previous meeting. The Panel Chair requests the Panel Secretary to read the minutes of the previous meeting. The Panel Chair invites the Panel members to raise points if there are any inconsistencies/discrepancies in the minutes of the provisional meetings. The Panel Secretary will incorporate the corrections/revisions, if there are any. The Panel Chair invites the Panel members to approve the minutes of the provisional meeting and to be seconded by the other Panel Members.

Step 6 – Discussion of “Business arising from the minutes. The Panel Chair discusses and resolves any unfinished business from a provisional meeting as identified by the Panel Members.

Step 7 – Review of protocols and protocol-related submissions. The Panel Chair and members review and discuss protocol and protocol-related submission. (Include the role of independent consultant and clarificatory issues) elaborate amendments/changes or recommendation... organize in an orderly manner, scientific issues. Review of protocol shall follow review assessment template:

7.1 Initial Review of Protocols

7.2. Review of Resubmissions

7.3. Review of After Approval Submissions

7.4. Report on Expedited Review of Protocols

7.5. Report on Expedited Review of After-Approval Submissions

7.6. Report of Site Visits

Step 8 – Report of results of expedited review. The Panel Secretary presents the list of approved expedited report protocols for their comments.

Step 9 – Report of protocols Exempted from review. The Panel Secretary presents the list of protocols exempted from review.

Step 10 – Discussion of operations-related matters. The Panel Chair presents matters that are operations related.

Step 11 – Adjournment. Meeting must be adjourned after all items in the agenda have been discussed and/or resolved. A Panel member must move for the adjournment of the meeting, and seconded, for it to be declared.

6. Forms

FR-004- Study Protocol Assessment Form

FR-005- Informed Consent Assessment Form

LET-008- Decision *Letter*

7. History of the Standard Operating Procedure

Version No.	Date	Authors	Main Change
1	March 2015	Mrs. Norqueen T. Dumadaug Prof. Antonietta H. Domen	First Draft
2	January 16, 2017	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	No changes
3	June 1, 2021	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	No changes
4	February 16, 2022	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy Ms. Jovelyn I. Legaspi	<i>Harmonized the flowchart with the detailed procedures.</i>
5	February 3, 2023	Dr. Joel G. Fernando	Workflow and Description of Procedures
6	August 2, 2023	Dr. Analyn D. Saavedra	<i>Glossary and References</i>

	PREPARATION OF THE MINUTES OF MEETINGS	SOP No.	20
		Version	6
		Date of Effectivity	24-Mar-2025

1. Statement of Policy

The meeting minutes shall be based on the approved agenda and shall be the basis of the decision letter on protocols.

2. Objective of the activity

The preparation of the minutes of the meeting ensures the proper documentation of the procedures and decisions in an REOC meeting.

3. Scope

This SOP includes REOC actions related to the documentation of the proceedings of a meeting, the final output of which is the minutes of the meeting. This SOP begins with the entry of preliminary information on the minutes template and ends with the filing of the approved minutes.

4. Workflow

Below are the different activities involved in the process of Preparation of the Minutes of Meetings and the responsible person/s in each of the activity.

Step No.	Activity	Responsible Person
1	Entry of the Preliminary Information on the Minutes' Template	REOC Secretary
2	Preparation of the Draft Minutes	REOC Secretary and Staff
3	Notation of the draft minutes	REOC Secretary
4	Approval of the minutes in the next REOC meeting	REOC Chair and Members
5	Filing of the approved minutes (SOP 23 on Managing Active Files)	REOC Staff

5. Description of Procedures

Step 1 – Entry of preliminary information on the minute’s template. The REOC Secretary does the entries of preliminary or relevant information on the minute’s template ahead of the meeting date (e.g. protocol-related information, other matters).

Step 2 – Preparation of the Draft Minutes. The REOC Secretary will do the preparation of the draft minutes. REOC staff records the proceedings of the meeting using the methods of real-time as seen projected on the screen, with audio recording and notes taking. REOC Secretary documents the discussion as the agenda is developed and discussed, with respective reasons for protocol-related actions- like comments and recommendations on the scientific issues, ethical issues, and informed consent form issues. REOC staff will do the documentations the entire duration of the REOC meeting.

Step 3 – Notation of the draft minutes. The REOC Secretary will draft the summary of each meeting discussion and decision in a concise and easy-to-read style in the minutes within 7 working days before the REOC meeting is conducted. REOC chair approves the drafted minutes which includes the following items:

- Date and venue of meeting
- REOC Members attendance (members present and absent)
- Presence of Independent consultants, primary investigators, guests, and observer’s attendance (if any)
- Time when the meeting was called to order
- Declaration of Quorum
- Name of Presiding officer
- Conflict of Interest (COI) declaration
- Items discussed, issues raised, and resolutions
- REOC decisions and recommendations
- Name and signature of person who prepared the minutes
- Name and signature of the REOC Chair and date of notation

Step 4 – Approval of the minutes in the next REOC meeting. Approval of the minutes is done through a formal motion from any REOC member and seconded accordingly. The REOC Secretary will check the correctness and completeness of the minutes and presents the minutes to the REOC Chair for review and approval within 7 working days. The REOC Chair indicates approval by signing the written minutes. The REOC staff will email the minutes of the meeting to the REOC members after obtaining approval from the REOC Chair.

Step 5 – Storage of the approved minutes. The REOC staff will enclose the original version of the minutes including succeeding revision in the minutes file. The REOC maintains a central file of all meeting minutes in chronological order to facilitate retrieval. See SOP 23 on Managing Active Files.

6. Forms

FR-008 - Minutes of the Meeting

7. History of the Standard Operating Procedure

Version No.	Date	Authors	Main Change
1	March 2015	Mrs. Norqueen T. Dumadaug Prof. Antonietta H. Domen	First Draft
2	January 16, 201	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	No changes
3	June 1, 2021	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	No changes
4	February 16, 2022	Mr. Jerry Paul L. Caitum CERP Chair/REOC member	Changes in the Statement of Policy, Purpose, Scope, Flowchart, and Description of Procedure
5	February 3, 2023	Prof. Swidin S. Husin	Workflow and Description of Procedures
6	August 2, 2023	Dr. Analyn D. Saavedra	<i>Glossary and References</i>

 	COMMUNICATING RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE (REOC) DECISION	SOP No.	21
		Version	3
		Date of Effectivity	24-Mar-2025

1. Statement of Policy

The REOC shall communicate its decisions to the researcher within (20) days for full review, fifteen (15) days for expedited review (reasonable time frame not later than six weeks) after the receipt of a complete set of submission documents. The communication document shall include clear instructions/recommendations for guidance of the researcher, must be written on an official stationery of the REOC and signed by the REOC chair.

2. Objective of the activity

The management of communicating ERP decisions ensures that all stakeholders are appropriately, accurately, and timely informed of the outcomes of the ERP's deliberations.

3. Scope

This SOP covers REOC actions related to communicating ERP's decisions to a research protocol submitted using the approval form. The ERP members ensure all issues and findings are finalized either at the ERP or committee level. This SOP starts with finalization of recommendations of the committee and ends with the filing of the documents and managing active files and updating of protocol databases.

4. Workflow

Below are the different activities involved in the process of Communicating Ethics Review Panel (ERP) Decision and the responsible person/s in each of the activity.

Step No.	Activity	Responsible Person
1	Finalization of recommendations of the committee (in case of SOP 05 on full review) or Finalization of recommendations of reviewers (in case of SOP 04 on Expedited Review)	ERP Chair
2	Transfer of information from meeting minutes or reports to REOC decision forms or templates	REOC Staff & ERP Secretary

3	Approval of the REOC Decision Documents	REOC Chair
4	Transmittal of REOC Decision to Researcher/s	REOC Staff
5	Filing of the Decision Document in the Protocol File SOP 23 on Managing Active Files and Update of Protocol Database	REOC Staff

5. Description of Procedures

Step 1 – Finalization of recommendations of the committee (in case of full review) or ERP members (in case of expedited review). Finalization of committee's recommendations will follow the same process stipulated in SOP 6 on Full Review (or for finalization of ERP Reviewers' Recommendations, see SOP 5 on Expedited Review).

Step 2 – Transfer of Information from Meeting Minutes or Reports to REOC Decision Forms or Templates. Transfer of information from meeting minutes or reports to REOC decision forms or templates. Upon approval of the draft minutes, or finalization of the ERP members recommendations, the information will be relayed to the researchers thru an official communication (LET-005 – Approval Letter). The ERP secretary drafts the communication, with the ERP Chair overseeing within 5 days upon the receipt of the approved minutes of the review/meeting.

Step 3 – Approval of the REOC Decision Documents. The ERP Chair reviews, approves and signs the decision documents within 5 days after the decision has been made.

Step 4 – Transmittal of REOC Decision to Researcher/s. The REOC staff will release the result of the review thru email or pickup at the REOC Office a day after the approval of the REOC decision document.

Step 5 – Filing of the Decision Document in the Protocol File SOP 23 on Managing Active Files and Update of Protocol Database. The REOC staff files the LET-008 - Decision Letter, document and updates the protocol database following SOP 23 on Managing Active Files.

6. Forms

LET-008 - Decision Letter
LET-005 - Approval Letter

7. History of the Standard Operating Procedure

Version No.	Date	Authors	Main Change
1	February 16, 2022	Mr. Jerry Paul L. Caitum CERP Chair/REOC member	First Draft
2	February 3, 2023	Prof. Herne B. Esgurra	Workflow and Description of Procedures
3	August 2, 2023	Dr. Analyn D. Saavedra	<i>Glossary and References</i>

	MANAGEMENT OF INCOMING AND OUTGOING COMMUNICATIONS	SOP No.	22
		Version	3
		Date of Effectivity	24-Mar-2025

1. Statement of Policy

All communications shall be recorded accurately and appropriately in a physical log book and electronic database for monitoring and tracking purposes as evidence of quality service and efficient operations of the REOC. Protocol-related communications are separated from administrative communications. Incoming communications shall be acted upon promptly.

2. Objective of the activity

The management of REOC incoming and outgoing documents/communications aims to establish accountability and an efficient and effective tracking system.

3. Scope

This SOP covers REOC actions related to organizing incoming and outgoing documents and ensuring an appropriate REOC response. This SOP begins with the sorting of incoming/outgoing communications and ends with the filing of incoming/outgoing communications.

4. Workflow

Below are the different activities involved in the process of Management of Incoming and Outgoing Communications and the responsible person/s in each of the activity.

Step No.	Activity	Responsible Person
1	Sorting of incoming/outgoing communications	REOC Staff
2	Recording of incoming/outgoing communications	REOC Staff
3	Acting on incoming communications	REOC Chair & Vice Chair
4	Filing of incoming/outgoing communications and Updating of Databases	REOC Staff

5. Description of Procedures

Step 1 – Sorting of incoming/outgoing communications. The REOC Staff receives all communication documents via letters, official memoranda, or emails from all REOC clients such as researchers, sponsors, and/or regulating agencies. The REOC Staff forwards all incoming communications to the REOC Secretary for proper routing process. All protocol-related communication is forwarded to the REOC Secretary whereas all process-related communication is forwarded to the REOC Chair for appropriate decision. All outgoing communication must be acknowledged by the REOC Chair prior to its dissemination.

Step 2 – Recording of incoming/outgoing communications. The REOC Staff records all incoming/outgoing communications in the logbook and documents the date received, source (person who sent communication), subject, person who received communication, and action taken (with details of who received it from the REOC). The REOC Secretariat oversees the recording of all incoming/outgoing communications by checking its contents regularly.

Step 3 – Acting on communications. The REOC Secretary drafts a response for incoming communications, and forwards the draft to the REOC Chair or Vice Chair incorporating his/her signature for approval of its release.

Step 4 – Filing of incoming/outgoing communication. The REOC staff stores and files all copies of the incoming/outgoing communications in the appropriate filing system for protocol-related communications to the study protocol file while non-protocol-related documents are filed in the appropriate administrative file. The staff logs all related information for protocol related documents in the database for protocols. The REOC Secretariat oversees the storing and filing of all incoming/outgoing communications by checking its contents regularly.

6. Forms

Logbook for Incoming Communications

7. History of the Standard Operating Procedure

Version No.	Date	Authors	Main Change
1	February 16, 2022	Ms. Jehan L. Ibrahim	First Draft
2	February 3, 2023	Ms. Erelee Q. Salang	Workflow and Description of Procedures
3	August 2, 2023	Dr. Analyn D. Saavedra	<i>Glossary and References</i>

 	MANAGEMENT OF ACTIVE FILES	SOP No.	23
		Version	3
		Date of Effectivity	24-Mar-2025

1. Statement of Policy

Active files shall be kept in a secured cabinet, arranged in an orderly manner that shall allow easy identification and retrieval. Access to the active files shall be governed by SOP on Managing Access to Confidential (SOP No. 24).

2. Objective of the activity

The management of active files ensures accessibility, easy retrieval of current files, and protection of those that require confidentiality.

3. Scope

This SOP covers procedures related to protocols accepted for review, undergoing review, or having been approved by the REOC. This SOP begins with the classification and coding of active files and ends with the periodic updating of the file.

4. Workflow

Below are the different activities involved in the process of Management of Active Files and the responsible person/s in each of the activities.

Step No.	Activity	Responsible Person
1	Classification and Coding of Active Files	REOC Secretary and Staff
2	Preparation of the Protocol Folder	REOC Staff
3	Updating the Protocol File and Managing Database	REOC Secretary and Staff

5. Description of Procedures

Step 1: Classification and coding of Active Files. The REOC staff under the supervision of the REOC Secretary classifies active files as follows:

- Initial Submission
- Resubmission
- Progress Report

- Amendment
- Protocol Deviation
- Protocol Violation
- Early Termination
- Continuing Review
- Final Report/Close-Out Report

The REOC Staff assigns a code to the Initial Submission and indicates the same for the rest of the submissions related to the initial submission. The code consists of the year and the serial number that indicates the sequence order of receipt. For example, a protocol received in 2022 as the 2nd submission in that year will be coded as 2022-02.

Step 2: Preparation of the Protocol Folder. The REOC staff files all documents pertaining to a study in a vertical folder that is labelled on the front cover and along the spine with: Protocol Code – Study File – Proponent’s Family Name – Sponsor or Funding Agency. The REOC staff attaches a protocol index on the inside front cover that indicates the contents of the folder.

Step 3: Updating the Protocol File and Managing Database. The REOC staff ensures that the documents are filed in chronological order such that the most recent documents are topmost. These documents include the following:

- Protocol (original and revised) versions
- Informed consent (Original and Revised) versions
- Reports: Progress, Protocol Deviation/Violation, Final, Amendment, Early Termination, Site Visit Reports
- Assessment Forms for each of the submitted and reviewed reports which should be signed and dated
- Excerpts of Minutes of Meetings when the protocol and reports were included in the agenda
- Decision and Approval Letters
- Communications

The REOC staff updates the protocol index each time a new document is added to the file. The protocol folder is periodically checked by the REOC Secretary member for orderliness and completeness. Finally, the REOC staff makes the entry and updates of the submission in the protocol database.

6. Forms

Logbook for Incoming Communications

7. History of the Standard Operating Procedure

Version No.	Date	Authors	Main Change
1	February 16, 2022	Ms. Jehan L. Ibrahim	First Draft
2	February 3, 2023	Ms. Erelee Q. Salang	Workflow and Description of Procedures
3	August 2, 2023	Dr. Analyn D. Saavedra	<i>Glossary and References</i>

 	ARCHIVING	SOP No.	24
		Version	5
		Date of Effectivity	24-Mar-2025

1. Statement of Policy

The REOC shall archive protocol of studies submitted for review (a) with approved/ accepted Final Reports, (b) with approved Early Termination reports and (c) whose researcher has not resubmitted a response to the REOC recommendation after receiving the Notification Letter within 3 months. Included in its archiving policy are the files of studies which have been terminated or completed or declared inactive and shall be kept in a separate secured storage for 3 years following WMSU ISO 9001:2015 standards. A coding data system shall also be in place for easy retrieval of files. Archived files can be retrieved only upon writing a request for retrieval addressed to the REOC Chair and upon approval.

2. Objective of the activity

The archiving of inactive, terminated, or completed protocols guarantees competent retrieval of information from the files for reference and compliance with national and international guidelines.

3. Scope

This SOP includes procedures related to storage and retrieval of protocols that are classified as inactive, terminated or completed. This SOP begins with the acceptance of final or early termination reports and identification of a protocol as inactive and ends with the inclusion of the files in the archives and update of the protocol database.

4. Workflow

Below are the different activities involved in the process of Archiving and the responsible person/s in each of the activities.

Step No.	Activity	Responsible Person
1	Acceptance of Final or Early Termination Reports (SOP 13) on Review of Final Reports, Review of Early Termination Reports (SOP 14), and Identification of a Protocol as Inactive.	REOC Chair, REOC Staff and ERP

2	Updating of Corresponding Protocol Folder	REOC Staff
3	Transfer of the Protocol Folder in the Archives and Update of the Protocol Database	REOC Staff

5. Description of Procedure

Step 1 – Acceptance of Final or Early Termination Reports on Review of Final Reports, Review of Early Termination Reports and Identification of a Protocol as Inactive. The REOC approve or accept the final report or early termination report during a meeting (SOP 13 on Review of Final, Report; SOP 14 on Review of an Early Termination Report). In the identification of an Inactive File, the REOC Secretary informs the REOC Members of the failure of a concerned researcher to respond to the recommendations of the REOC in the last 3 months during which time the researcher has been appropriately reminded of the requirement. This shall be included in the agenda of the next meeting where the protocol will be declared inactive.

Step 2 – Updating the Corresponding Protocol Folder. The REOC staff files the Final or Early termination report in the corresponding protocol folder, including the excerpts of the minutes that approved the report or declared the protocol as inactive.

Step 3 – Transfer of the Protocol Folder in the Archives and Update of the Protocol Database. The REOC staff checks whether the documents listed in the protocol file index are complete and removes unimportant documents. Thereafter, the REOC staff transfers the folder to the archive section and updates the protocol database.

6. Forms

Form ## Borrower's Log (from University Records Office)

7. History of the Standard Operating Procedure

Version No.	Date	Authors	Main Change
1	March 2015	Dr. Jocelyn P. Pedroso Ms. Jovelyn I. Legaspi	First Draft
2	January 16, 2017	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	No changes
3	June 1, 2021	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	No changes
4	February 3, 2023	Dr. Dulce Amor P. Matondo	Workflow and Description of Procedures
5	August 2, 2023	Dr. Analyn D. Saavedra	Glossary and References

	MANAGEMENT OF ACCESS TO CONFIDENTIAL FILES	SOP No.	25
		Version	3
		Date of Effectivity	24-Mar-2025

1. Statement of Policy

Access to REOC confidential files shall be regulated and limited to REOC Members and Staff. Other persons such as institutional authorities, regulatory agencies, or sponsors with legitimate interests on the files can be allowed access only with proper justification. Researchers shall be allowed access only to their own protocol files if requested.

Confidential files shall include study protocol-related documents (e.g. protocols, case report forms, informed consent documents, scientific documents, expert opinions or reviews), meeting minutes, decisions, action letters/notification of committee decision, approval letters, and study protocol-related communications. Confidentiality of documents is determined by the policies under the data privacy act of 2012.

Moreover, access to REOC confidential documents is subject to the following limitations:

- REOC Members and staff who have signed a Confidentiality Agreement and a Conflict of Interest Disclosure can request confidential documents outside of regular protocol review access.
- Non-members can request access to specific documents by submitting a formal written request. The REOC staff will provide a copy of the Agreement Form for Non-members requesting copies of REOC Documents, which must be completed and signed by the person making the request.
- Regulatory authorities have full access to REOC documents if it is within their mandates and upon reasonable notice to make the files available signed by the regulatory authority's recognized official.

2. Objective of the activity

Documents submitted to REOC are treated with confidentiality. The management of requests for access to confidential files helps to protect the rights of the researchers and research participants while also enhancing the REOCs' credibility and integrity.

3. Scope

This SOP consists of procedures in the handling and distribution of confidential files, which begins with the request for accessing confidential files with appropriate

classification of confidential REOC documents and ends with the return of the documents to the protocol folder.

4. Workflow

Below are the different activities involved in the process of Management of Access to Confidential Files and the responsible person/s in each of the activities.

Step No.	Activity	Responsible Person
1	Receipt and Logging of Requests for Access to Confidential Files	REOC Staff
2	Approval of Requests for Access and Retrieval of Documents	REOC Chair and REOC Staff
3	Supervision of the Use of Retrieved Documents	REOC Vice Chair & REOC Secretary
4	Return of Documents to the Files	REOC Staff

5. Description of Procedures

Step 1 – Receipt and Logging of Requests for Access to Confidential Files. The REOC staff receives the request for access to confidential files and refers this to the REOC Secretary. The REOC staff logs the request in the logbook.

Step 2 – Approval of Requests for Access and Retrieval of Documents. The REOC Chair reviews the request and determines approval or disapproval of the request for access based on the merits of the request, the authority of the requesting individual, the reason or justification for the access of records, and the acceptance on the terms of the confidentiality agreement. If the REOC chair approves the request for access to the confidential file, the REOC staff will ask the requesting individual to sign the confidentiality agreement and proceed towards the retrieval of documents.

Step 3 – Supervision of the Use of Retrieved Documents. The REOC Vice Chair and REOC Secretary will supervise the entire duration on the room-use of retrieved documents and limit photocopying to concerned researchers. Supervision will involve imposing restrictions, recording of copies made from the confidential documents, and logging all necessary information on the access. The REOC Secretary records the retrieval of REOC documents and records the following information in the log of request.

- Study file code
- Date borrowed

- Number of borrowers
- Name and signature of borrower upon retrieval
- Signature of REOC Secretary upon return
- Document copied
- Number of copies made
- Number of copies received

All informations are recorded by the REOC Secretary in the log book before copies of any documents are released. Only the REOC Secretary can reproduce the exact number of copies approved for replication. Upon receipt of the copies, the person who requested the copies will sign in the log book.

Step 4 – Return of Documents to the Files. The REOC Secretary ensures that the documents used are returned by the requesting individual after use. The REOC Secretary records the date and time and documents retrieved and returns all records in the protocol file.

6. Forms

Logbook

7. History of the Standard Operating Procedure

Version No.	Date	Authors	Main Change
1	February 16, 2022	Ms. Jehan L. Ibrahim	First Draft
2	February 3, 2023	Ms. Erelee Q. Salang	Workflow and Description of Procedures
3	August 2, 2023	Dr. Analyn D. Saavedra	<i>Glossary and References</i>

 	MANAGEMENT OF QUERIES AND COMPLAINTS	SOP No.	26
		Version	5
		Date of Effectivity	24-Mar-2025

1. Statement of Policy

Queries and complaints from clients, patients or research participants shall be attended to promptly and appropriately while exercising due diligence. The nature of queries shall determine whether they can be answered by REOC staff or referred to the ERP of the specific protocol. All complaints shall be referred to the ERP chair who shall determine the level of risk involved. Complaints of minimal risk shall be referred to the ERP for resolution. Complaints of more than minimal risk shall be taken up in a special meeting within 3-5 days for deliberation by the committee en banc with the ethics review panel leading to the discussion.

2. Objective of the activity

Managing queries and complaints aims to promote public trust and confidence in the institution, especially in REOC and to ensure that the rights and well-being of the participants are attended to.

3. Scope

This SOP applies only to questions and complaints from research participants or their families in studies that have received ethical approval from the REOC. And this begins with the receipt, logging, and acknowledgement of queries and complaints and ends with the logging of the response and inclusion in the agenda of the REOC meeting.

4. Workflow

Below are the different activities involved in the process of Management of Queries and Complaints and the responsible person/s in each of the activity.

Step No.	Activity	Responsible Person
1	Receipt, Logging, and Acknowledgement of Queries and Complaints (SOP on Managing REC Incoming and Outgoing Communications)	REOC Staff

2	Referral of Query or Complain to Competent Authority 2.1 Referral of Protocol-related Query 2.2. Referral of All Complaints to the REOC Chair	REOC Staff
3	Formulation of Response 3.1. Protocol-related Queries 3.2. Minimal-risk Complaints 3.3. More than Minimal Risk Complaints	ERP ERP REOC Members
4	Communication of Response (SOP 21 on Communicating REOC Decisions)	REOC Staff
5	Logging of the Response (SOP 22 on Managing REOC Incoming and Outgoing Communications) and Inclusion in the Agenda of the REOC Meeting (SOP 18 on Preparing the Meeting Agenda)	REOC Staff and REOC Secretary

5. Description of Procedures

Step 1 – Receipt, Logging and Acknowledgement of Queries and Complaints. The REOC Staff receives, logs, and transmits the query or complains to the REOC Chair thru the REOC Secretary

Step 2 – Referral of Query or Complain to Competent Authority

- 2.1. The REOC staff refers queries related to specific protocols approved by the REOC to the ERP.
- 2.2. On the other hand, the REOC staff refers all complaints to the REOC chair who determines the level of risk affected by the issue.
 - 2.2.1. Minimal risk complaints are referred to the ERP of the concerned protocol.
 - 2.2.2. Complaints that involve more than minimal risk are referred to the Committee through a special meeting that shall be called within 3 working days. The REOC staff notifies the concerned ERP that they will lead the discussion such that pertinent materials are provided to them as reference.

Step 3 – Formulation of Response

- 3.1. For queries, the primary reviewers accomplish the Form.018-Query Reply.
- 3.2. For minimal risk complaints, the primary reviewers accomplish Form.018 Complaints Resolution.

3.3. For more than minimal risk, the committee may choose any of the following options:

3.3.1. Constitute a site visiting team to gather more information, verification and clarification regarding the source and cause/s of the complaint for its early resolution.

3.3.2. Designate the ERP to meet with the complainants and the researcher (preferably separately) for clarification of issues and obtain suggestions for resolution.

3.3.3. Formulate recommendation if satisfied with the adequacy of information-

- request for explanation/justification from researcher
- accept request/demand of participant
- suspension of further recruitment
- amendment of protocol and re-consent of participants
- others

Step 4 – Communication of Response. The REOC Staff communicates the response or actions on the queries and complaints following the SOP 21 on Communicating ERP Decisions.

Step 5 – Logging of the Response and Inclusion in the Agenda of the REOC Meeting. The REOC staff logs the response of the complaints and queries and the REOC Secretary includes in the agenda of the REOC meeting.

6. Forms

FR-018 - Query/Complaint Form

7. History of the Standard Operating Procedure

Version No.	Date	Authors	Main Change
1	March 2015	Mr. Ryan Joseph Dela Torre Mr. Clarito F. Concepcion Dr. Fredelino M. San Juan	First Draft
2	January 16, 2017	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	No changes
3	June 1, 2021	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy	No changes
	February 16, 2022	Dr. Mario J. Gapoy Ms. Jovelyn I. Legaspi	<i>Harmonized the flowchart with the detailed procedures, and replaced panel reviewers to primary reviewers.</i>
4	February 3, 2022	Dr. Joel G. Fernando	Workflow and Description of Procedures
5	August 2, 2023	Dr. Analyn D. Saavedra	<i>Glossary and References</i>

 	WRITING AND REVISING SOPs	SOP No.	27
		Version	3
		Date of Effectivity	24-Mar-2025

1. Statement of Policy

The REOC shall designate a team to annually review its set of SOPs to determine its continuing relevance and effectiveness to its operations. This is to ensure efficiency, transparency, and consistency of REOC operations. The SOP manual needs to be periodically reviewed to determine the need for revision or new SOPs in order to respond to emerging operational issues of the REOC in accordance with University's policies.

2. Objective of the activity

Writing and revising SOPs ensures continuing quality assurance of REOC functions.

3. Scope

This SOP applies to all REOC activities involved in the development of its SOPs and their revisions as published and distributed by the institution. This SOP begins with proposal and approval for revision or writing of a new SOP and ends with the inclusion of the new or revised SOP in the SOP Manual and its dissemination.

4. Workflow

Below are the different activities involved in the process of Writing and Revising SOPs and Complaints and the responsible person/s in each of the activities.

Step No.	Activity	Responsible Person
1	Proposal and Approval for Revision or Writing of a New SOP	REOC Members
2	Designation of the SOP Team	REOC Chair
3	Drafting of the Revision or New SOP	REOC members
4	Review and Finalization of SOP	REOC members
5	Submission of Finalized SOP to the Institutional Authority	REOC Chair
6	Inclusion of the New or Revised SOP in the SOP Manual and its Dissemination	REOC Chair members

5. Description of Procedures

Step 1 – Proposal and Approval for Revision or Writing of a New SOP.

Any REOC member may propose revisions to the SOPs by submitting a written proposal to the REOC Chair. The initiation of a request for new SOPs or amendments to existing ones will begin when approval has been granted through a consensus in a regular or special meeting, or via referendum with a majority of signifying REOC members.

Step 2 – Designation of the SOP Team. The REOC Chair assigns five (5) members from the list of the REOC members who will constitute the SOP Team who will draft the revised SOP.

Step 3 – Drafting of the Revision or New SOP. The REOC members draft the revisions or the new SOP. In writing or revising the SOP, the template prescribed by PHREB will be used with the following contents:

- (a) Title, which is descriptive of contents
- (b) Policy statement
- (c) Objective/s of the activity, which defines the purpose and intended outcome
- (d) Scope, which defines the extent of coverage of the SOP and its limitations
- (e) Workflow provides a graphic representation of the essential steps to implement the SOP and the responsible person for each step.
- (f) Detailed instructions, which elaborates the steps listed in workflow
- (g) Glossary – acronyms and terms which need to be defined
- (h) Forms, documents to be accomplished by different parties as required by the SOP,
- (i) Document history which tabulates the different versions (from draft to final versions) of the document by author, version, date, and description of main changes
- (j) References, which lists the instruments use to draft the Guideline such as other SOPs, guidelines, or policies

The revised SOP will also be coded using the format adopted by the latest PHREB Standard Operating Procedures.

Step 4 – Review and Finalization of SOP. Once the draft version is ready, the revised SOP will be included as one of the agenda in the next meeting. Review of the drafted SOP and approval shall be done via acceptance of the majority votes conducted during a regular or special meeting.

Step 5 – Submission of Finalized SOP to the Institutional Authority. The REOC Chair submits the approved draft to the VP RESEL and forwards it to the University President for final approval. The University President, VP RESEL and REOC Chair approves the SOP by signing in the appropriate

section on the cover page. The approved SOPs will be implemented from the date of approval by the University President.

Step 6 – Inclusion of the New or Revised SOP in the SOP Manual and its Dissemination. Upon approval of the new or revised SOP, the REOC Staff distributes the revised SOP to REOC members within thirty (30) days of approval by the head of institution for hard copies and immediately for e-copies. The REOC Staff retains one copy of the complete originally signed SOP. The old SOP is marked superseded and is ready for archiving.

6. Forms

FR-020 – SOP Template

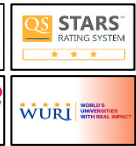
7. History of the Standard Operating Procedure

Version No.	Date	Authors	Main Change
1	February 16, 2022	Ms. Jehan L. Ibrahim	<i>First Draft</i>
2	February 3, 2022	Dr. Joel G. Fernando	Workflow and Description of Procedures
3	August 2, 2023	Dr. Analyn D. Saavedra	<i>Glossary and References</i>

Forms, Letter Templates, Clearance and Certificate



Western Mindanao State University
Research Extension Services and External Linkage
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Zamboanga City, 7000, Philippines
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Curriculum Vitae

Surname: Click here to enter text.	First Name: Click here to enter text.	Middle Name: Click here to enter text.
Date of Birth: Click here to enter text.	Gender: Click here to enter text.	
ERP Position: ☐ Chair ☐ Member ☐ Alternate Member	Address: Click here to enter text.	
Date of 1st Appointment: Click here to enter text.	Contact No.: Click here to enter text.	
Term of Office Click here to enter text.	E-mail: Click here to enter text.	
Education Background: 1.1 Bachelor's degree - Click here to enter text. 1.2 Graduate degree - Click here to enter text. 1.3 Post-Graduate degree - Click here to enter text. 1.4 Other qualifications and specializations - Click here to enter text.		
Research Ethics Training attended:		Date of Attendance
Click here to enter text.		Click here to enter text.
Click here to enter text.		Click here to enter text.
Click here to enter text.		Click here to enter text.
Work Experience:		
Present Work Experience	Click here to enter text.	
Previous Work Experience	Click here to enter text.	

Signature : _____

Date : _____



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Research Ethics Review APPLICATION FORM

Date: _____

To: WMSU REOC
WMSU, Zamboanga City

Sir/Madam:

Greetings!

The undersigned do hereby request for the review of this research protocol entitled _____ as a requirement for my (undergraduate thesis, graduate thesis, institutionally funded research, externally funded research) for the grant of its RESEARCH ETHICS CLEARANCE.

Attached herewith are the following relevant documents:

- ☐ Research Protocol/Proposal
- ☐ Technical Review Clearance
- ☐ Data collection instrument/s
- ☐ Informed Consent/Assent (*if applicable*)
- ☐ Curriculum Vitae of Researcher/s
- ☐ Completed Study Protocol Assessment Form
- ☐ Completed Informed Consent Assessment Form
- ☐ Completed Exempt Review Assessment Form

I certify thereof the truthfulness of the attached documents.

Thank you very much.

Researcher's Signature over Printed Name

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

Acknowledge receipt of this research package as:

- ☐ Incomplete: Returned with instruction for compliance.
- ☐ Complete: Accepted for Review

Kindly contact _____ for follow – up.

WMSU REOC Code: _____

REOC Staff



Western Mindanao State University
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CONFIDENTIALITY AGREEMENT AND CONFLICT OF INTEREST DISCLOSURE

(For Members, Observers or Guests of the National Ethics Committee)

I sign this document as _____ of the Research Ethics Oversight Committee for Human Research and voluntarily agree not to disclose or reproduce any confidential information and/or research protocols under consideration during the course of my activities with the Committee, or anytime afterwards.

Confidentiality

Any written information provided to the ***Undersigned*** that is of a Confidential, Privileged, or Proprietary in nature shall be identified accordingly. Written Confidential information provided for review shall not be copied or retained. All Confidential information (and any copies and notes thereof) shall remain the sole property of the WMSU REOC.

Conflict of Interest

It is recognized that the potential for conflict of interest will always exist; however, there is concomitant faith in the ability of the WMSU REOC to manage these conflict issues, if any, in such a way that the ultimate outcome of the protection of human subjects remains.

It is the policy of the WMSU REOC that no member may participate in the review, comment, or approval of any activity in which he/she has a conflict of interest except to provide information as requested by the WMSU REOC.

The ***Undersigned*** will immediately disclose to the WMSU REOC Chair any actual or potential conflict of interest that he/she may have in relation to any particular proposal submitted for review by the Board, and to abstain from any participation in discussions or recommendations in respect of such proposals.

In case I have to disclose the confidential information by court order, I will so inform the committee within two days after notification.

Signature over printed name _____

Institutional Affiliation _____

Address _____

Noted

REOC Chair

Date _____



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STUDY PROTOCOL ASSESSMENT FORM

Study Protocol Title			
WMSU REOC Code		Type of Review	☐ Expedited ☐ Full
Researcher		ERP	☐ Chair ☐ Member
Name of Adviser		Institution*	
Name of Reviewer		Date Received	
Guide questions for reviewing the proposal / protocol			Page & Line Number*
Does the study have social value? Comment: (e.g. relevance to national /community needs)			☐ Unable to Assess ☐ Yes ☐ No
Is the study background adequate? Comment:			☐ Unable to Assess ☐ Yes ☐ No
Are the research questions supported by the Review of Literature? Comment:			☐ Unable to Assess ☐ Yes ☐ No
Are the study objectives Specific, Measurable, Attainable, Realistic, Time-bound? Comment:			☐ Unable to Assess ☐ Yes ☐ No
Does the research need to be carried out with human participants? Comment:			☐ Unable to Assess ☐ Yes ☐ No
Is the research design appropriate? • Is the population identified and defined? Comment:			☐ Unable to Assess ☐ Yes ☐ No

Is the selection of study participants described? Comment:	☐ Unable to Assess ☐ Yes ☐ No	
Is the sample size justified? Comment:	☐ Unable to Assess ☐ Yes ☐ No	
Is the plan for data analysis described? Comment:	☐ Unable to Assess ☐ Yes ☐ No	
Are there dummy tables? Comment:	☐ Unable to Assess ☐ Yes ☐ No	
Is the research tool appropriate for the study? (survey questionnaire, interview questions) Comment:	☐ Unable to Assess ☐ Yes ☐ No	
Are there measures to protect privacy of participants and confidentiality of data? Comment:	☐ Unable to Assess ☐ Yes ☐ No	
Does the study have a vulnerability issue? Comment:	☐ Unable to Assess ☐ Yes ☐ No	
Are appropriate mechanisms/interventions in place to address the vulnerability issue/s? Comment:	☐ Unable to Assess ☐ Yes ☐ No	
Are there risks/ probable harms to the human participants in the study? Comment:	☐ Unable to Assess ☐ Yes ☐ No	
Are there measures to mitigate the risks? Comment:	☐ Unable to Assess ☐ Yes ☐ No	

Is the informed consent procedure / form adequate and culturally appropriate? Comment:	☐ Unable to Assess ☐ Yes ☐ No	
Is/are the investigator/s and adviser/s adequately trained and do they have sufficient experience to undertake the study? Comment:	☐ Unable to Assess ☐ Yes ☐ No	
Is there a disclosure of conflict of interest? Comment:	☐ Unable to Assess ☐ Yes ☐ No	
Are the research facilities adequate? Comment:	☐ Unable to Assess ☐ Yes ☐ No	
Are there any other concerns in the study? Comment:	☐ Unable to Assess ☐ Yes ☐ No	

Recommendation:

- ☐ **Approved**
☐ **Minor revision/s required**

- ☐ **Major revision/s required**

- ☐ **Disapproved**
Reasons for disapproval:

Name and Signature of Primary Reviewer

Review Date



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INFORMED CONSENT ASSESSMENT FORM

Study Protocol Title			
WMSU REOC Code		Type of Review	☐ Expedited ☐ Full
Researcher		ERP	☐ Chair ☐ Member
Name of Adviser		Institution	
Name of Reviewer		Date Received	
Guide questions for reviewing the informed consent process and form			Page & Line Number*
Is it necessary to seek the informed consent of the participants? ☐ Unable to Assess ☐ Yes ☐ No <u>If NO, please explain.</u>			
<u>If YES</u> , are the participants provided with sufficient information regarding:			
Purpose of the study?	☐ Yes ☐ No		
Expected duration of participation?	☐ Yes ☐ No		
Does the protocol include an adequate process for ensuring that consent is voluntary?	☐ Yes ☐ No		
Procedures to be carried out?	☐ Yes ☐ No		
Discomforts and inconveniences?	☐ Yes ☐ No		
Risks (including possible social, physical, emotional, and psychological)?	☐ Yes ☐ No		
Random assignment to experimental and control group?	☐ Not applicable ☐ Yes ☐ No		
Benefits to the participants?	☐ Yes ☐ No		
Compensations/reimbursements of expenses	☐ Yes ☐ No		
Participants may withdraw from the study anytime without any penalty?	☐ Yes ☐ No		
Duties and responsibilities of the participants are duly stated?	☐ Yes ☐ No		
Extent of confidentiality?	☐ Yes ☐ No		
Is the informed consent written or presented in simple language that participants can understand?	☐ Yes ☐ No		

Do you have any other concerns?	
Who to contact for pertinent questions and/ for assistance in the research-related injury?	

Recommendation: ☐ **Approved**
☐ **Minor revisions required**

☐ **Major revisions required**

☐ **Disapproved**

Reasons for disapproval:

Name and Signature of Primary Reviewer

Review Date



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EXEMPT REVIEW ASSESSMENT FORM

STUDY PROTOCOL INFORMATION

Reference Number	
WMSU REOC code number	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Study Protocol Submission Date	

INSTRUCTIONS

To the Primary Reviewer: Please evaluate how the exemption criteria outlined below apply to the study protocol by confirming the submitted information and putting your comments in the space provided under "REVIEWER COMMENTS." Finalize your review by indicating your conclusions under "RECOMMENDED ACTION" and signing in space provided for the primary reviewer.

CRITERIA FOR EXEMPTION	To be filled out by the Primary Reviewer			REVIEWER COMMENTS
	Indicate if the assessment point applies to the study protocol		Page & Line Number	
1. PROTOCOL ASSESSMENT	YES	NO		
1.1. Does this research involve human participants?				
1.2. Does this research involve use of non-identifiable human tissue/ biological samples?				
1.3. Does this research involve use of non-identifiable publicly available data? <i>*Protocols that neither involve human participants, nor identifiable human tissue, biological samples and data shall be exempted from review (NEGHR 2017)</i>				
1.4. Does this research involve interaction with human participants?				
1.5. Type of research 1.5.1. Institutional quality assurance 1.5.2. Evaluation of public service program 1.5.3. Public health surveillance 1.5.4. Educational evaluation activities 1.5.5. Consumer acceptability test <i>*These 5 have been identified in the NEGHR as exemptible, as long as it does not involve more than minimal risk.</i>				

1.6. What is/are the method/s of data collection (<i>please tick appropriate box</i>) 1.6.1. Surveys and/or questionnaire, Interviews, or observations of public behavior 1.6.2. Audio/video recordings of public behavior 1.6.3. Research which only uses existing data <i>*These have been identified in the NEGHR as exemptible, as long as anonymity and/or confidentiality is maintained.</i>				
1.7. Will the collected data be anonymized or de-identified?				
1.8. Is there a data protection plan? <i>Measures or guarantees to protect privacy and confidentiality of participant information and in compliance with the Data Privacy Act of 2012 as indicated by data collection methods including data protection plans including the steps to be taken so that all who have access to the data and the identities of the respondents can safeguard privacy and confidentiality (ex. providing adequate instructions to research assistants, transcribers, or translators) (NEGRIHP 2022); Plan on processing personal data, storage of data, access, disposal, and terms of use (NEGRIHP 2022; Data Privacy Act of 2012)</i>				
1.9. Is this research likely to involve any foreseeable risk of harm or discomfort to participants; above the level experienced in everyday life? (NEGRIHP 2022) <i>*Please refer to section 2. Risk Assessment, prior to answering this item</i> <i>*If YES, then this protocol does not qualify for exemption</i>				
2. RISK ASSESSMENT	YES	NO	Page & Line Number	
1.1. Does this research involve the following (<i>please select all that apply</i>):				
1.1.1. Any vulnerable groups?				
1.1.2. Sensitive topics that may make participants feel uncomfortable (<i>i.e. sexual behaviour, illegal activities, racial biases, etc.</i>)				
1.1.3. Use of drugs				
1.1.4. Invasive procedure (e.g. blood sampling) and specify				
1.1.5. Physical stress/distress, discomfort				
1.1.6. Psychological/mental stress/distress				
1.1.7. Deception of/or withholding information from subjects				
1.1.8. Access to data by individuals or organizations other than the investigators				
1.1.9. Conflict of interest issues				
1.1.10. Or any other ethical dilemmas				
1.1.11. Is there any blood sampling involved in the study?				

RECOMMENDED ACTION:

- ☐ QUALIFIED FOR EXEMPTION
- ☐ NOT QUALIFIED FOR EXEMPTION

SUMMARY OF RECOMMENDATIONS:

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.
- 4.
- 5.

JUSTIFICATION FOR RECOMMENDED ACTION

ERP CHAIR

Signature _____

Date:

Name _____

REOC CHAIR

Signature _____

Date:

Name _____



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REVIEW OF RESUBMITTED STUDY PROTOCOL FORM

WMSU REOC Code:		Date of Initial Submission:	
Study Protocol Title:			
Total Participants:		☐ 2 nd Review	☐ 3 rd Review
Researcher:			Mobile No.:
Initial Review Date:		Last Review Date:	
Recommendations from last review: 1. 2. 3. 4. 5.		Were the recommendations met (Yes/No)? Explain 1. 2. 3. 4. 5.	
Recommendation of Ethics Review Panel: ☐ Approval ☐ Minor Modification ☐ Major Modification ☐ Disapproval		Justification for recommendation:	

PRIMARY REVIEWERS:

LAY MEMBER:	Signature
Date:	Name
SCIENTIST:	Signature
Date:	Name
REOC CHAIR:	Signature
Date:	Name



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REVIEW OF AMENDMENT FORM

General Information			
Title of Study			
Version number/ date of the REOC approved protocol			
REOC Code (To be provided by REOC)		Study Site	
Name of Researcher		Contact information	Tel. No.:
Co-Researcher/s (if any)			Mobile No.:
			Email:
Institution of Researcher			
Address of Institution			
Effective period of ethical clearance	From	To	

Procedures/provisions to be amended (Use additional sheets if necessary)	Original Procedure/ Provision	Proposed Amendment/s	Justification

Researcher:

Signature over printed Name

Date

Recommendations/Decision: (To be filled up by the Ethics Review Panel)

Minor Modification (Expedited Review):

☐	do not entail more than minimal risk to the participants
☐	do not have participants belonging to a vulnerable group
☐	study procedures do not generate vulnerability to the participants

Major Modification (Full Review):

☐	entail more than minimal risk to the participants
☐	participants are members of a vulnerable group
☐	study procedures generate vulnerability to the participants

Comments:

Reviewer:

Signature over printed Name

Date



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PROGRESS REPORTS

Instructions to the Researcher: Please accomplish this form and ensure that you have included in your submission the documents that you have checked below.

General Information			
*Title of Study			
*REOC Code (To be provided by REOC)		*Study Site	
*Name of Researcher		Contact Information	*Tel. No:
*Co-researcher (if any)			*Mobile No:
			*Email:
*Institution			
*Address of Institution			
Ethical Clearance effectivity period			
Progress Report			
1. Start of Study			
2. Expected end of Study			
3. No. of enrolled participants			
4. No. of required participants			
5. No. of participants who withdrew			
6. Deviations from the approved protocol			
7. Summary of SAEs, RNEs			
8. New information (literature or in the conduct of the study) That may significantly change the risk-benefit ratio			
9. Issues/problems encountered			



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PROTOCOL VIOLATION/DEVIATION REPORT FORM

Instructions to the Researcher: Please accomplish this form and ensure that you have included in your submission the documents that you checked.

General Information			
Title of Study			
REOC Code (To be provided by REOC)		Study Site	
Name of Researcher		Contact information	Tel. No.:
Co-Researcher/s (if any)			Mobile No.:
			Email:
Institution of Researcher			
Address of Institution			
Ethical Clearance effectivity period	From	To	
Progress Report			
1. Start of Study		2. Expected end of Study	
3. Number of enrolled participants		4. Number of required participants	
5. Number of participants who withdrew			
6. Deviations from the approved protocol		7. Explanation for deviation/violation	
8. Impact of deviation/violation on participants' risks/harms and integrity of data		9. Action is taken to prevent future deviation/violation	

Recommendations/Decision: (To be filled up by the Primary Reviewers)



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REPORTABLE NEGATIVE EVENT (RNE) FORM

Researcher:		WMSU REOC Code:	
Co-Researcher: <i>(if any)</i>			
Study Protocol Title:			
Study Site:		Contact Information	
		Telephone No:	
		Mobile No:	
		Email:	
Institution:			
Address of Institution:			
Ethical Clearance effectivity period			
RNE Report			
1. Start of study		2. Expected end of study	
3. Number of enrolled participants		4. Number of required participants	
5. Description of Negative (harms, risks) Events		6. Actions taken to prevent future RNEs, interventions and outcomes	
a. Involving Participants			
b. Involving members of the Study Team			
c. Involving Data safety and integrity			
7. Recommendations			



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CONTINUING REVIEW FORM

Instructions to the Researcher: Please accomplish this form and ensure that you have included in your submission the documents that you checked in Section 3. Checklist of Documents.

General Information			
Title of Study			
REOC Code		Study Site	
Name of Researcher		Contact information	Tel. No.:
			Mobile No.:
Co-Researcher/s (if any)			Email:
Institution of Researcher			
Address of Institution			
Ethical Clearance effectivity period	From	To	
Progress Report			
1. Start of Study		2. Expected end of Study	
3. Number of enrolled participants		4. Number of required participants	
5. Number of participants who withdrew			
6. Deviations from the approved protocol		7. New information (literature or in the conduct of the study) that may significantly change the risk-benefit ratio	
8. Issues/problems encountered			
9. Justification for application for Continuing Review			



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SITE VISIT REPORT FORM

Instructions to the Researcher: Please accomplish this form and ensure that you have included in your submission.

General Information			
*Title of Study			
*REOC Code (To be provided by REOC)		*Study Site	
*Name of Researcher		Contact Information	*Tel No:
*Co-researcher (if any)			*Mobile No:
			*Email:
*Institution			
*Address of Institution			
Ethical clearance effectivity period			
Site Visit Report			
Start of study		Expected end of study	
Number of enrolled participants		Number of required participants	
Reasons for Site Visit		Person/s present during visit	
Findings		Recommendations	

Site Visit Team

1. —
2. —
3. —

Report submitted by:

Name and signature

Date: _____



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REVIEW OF AN EARLY TERMINATION REPORT

Instructions to the Researcher: Please accomplish this form and ensure that you have included in your submission the documents that you checked in Section 3. Checklist of Documents.

General Information			
Title of Study			
WMSU REOC Code		Study Site	
Name of Researcher		Contact information	Tel. No.:
Co-Researcher/s (if any)			Mobile No.:
			Email:
Institution of Researcher			
Address of Institution			
Ethical Clearance effectivity period	From	To	
Recommended by:	(e.g. Sponsor, Funding Agency, Data Safety Monitoring Board, Researcher/Proponent)		
Early Termination Report			
1. Start of Study		2. Expected end of Study	
3. Number of enrolled participants		4. Number of required participants	
5. Reason/s for termination		6. Support mechanisms/interventions for Enrolled Participants	
7. Post-Termination Actions			

Name and Signature of Researcher

Date: _____



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FINAL REPORT FORM

General Information			
*Title of Study			
Version number/date of the REOC approved protocol			
*REOC Code (To be provided by REOC)		*Study Site	
*Name of Researcher		Contact Information	*Tel No:
*Co-researcher/s (if any)			*Mobile No:
			*Email:
*Institution of researcher			
*Address of Institution			
Effective period of ethical clearance	From:		To:

Final Report	
1. Start of study	2. End of study
3. Number of enrolled participants	4. Number of required participants
5. Number of participants who withdrew	
6. Deviations from the approved protocol	7. Issues/problems encountered
8. Summary of findings:	
9. Conclusions:	
10. Actions for dissemination of study results:	

Signature of Researcher: _____

Date: _____



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MEETING AGENDA

Date of issuance: _____

TO: <NAME OF WMSU REOC Members>:

Name 1

Name 2

Name 3

Name 4

DATE OF MEETING

TIME OF MEETING

VENUE OF MEETING

AGENDA:

Call to order

1. Determination of quorum and presence of non-institutional members
2. Disclosure of Conflict of interest
3. Reading and approval of the Minutes of the last meeting
4. Business arising from the Minutes of the last meeting
5. Protocol review

5.1. FULL REVIEW

5.1.1. Study Protocols for Initial Review

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Submission Date	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Type of review	
Ethics Review Panel	
Sponsor	

5.1.2. Resubmissions of Study Protocols for Modification

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Submission Date	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Type of review	
Ethics Review Panel	
Sponsor	

5.1.3. Study Protocols for Clarificatory Interview

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Submission Date	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Type of review	
Ethics Review Panel	
Sponsor	

5.1.4. Withdrawal of Study Protocol Applications

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Submission Date	
Withdrawal Application Date	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Type of review	
Ethics Review Panel	
Sponsor	

5.1.5. Study Protocol Amendment Applications

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Submission Date	
Amendment Submission Date	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Type of review	
Ethics Review Panel	
Sponsor	

5.1.6. Continuing Review Applications

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Submission Date	
Application Date	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Type of review	
Ethics Review Panel	
Sponsor	

5.1.7. Final Reports

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Submission Date	
Report Date	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Type of review	
Ethics Review Panel	
Sponsor	

5.1.8. Study Protocol Non-Compliance (Deviation or Violation) Reports

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Approval Date	
Report Date	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Type of review	
Ethics Review Panel	
Sponsor	

5.1.9. Early Study Termination Application

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Approval Date	
Application Date	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Type of review	
Ethics Review Panel	
Sponsor	

5.1.10. Queries or Complaints

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Approval Date	
Report Date	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Type of review	
Ethics Review Panel	
Sponsor	

5.1.11. Site Visit Reports:

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Approval Date	
Site Visit Date	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Type of review	
Ethics Review Panel	
Sponsor	

6. Other Matters

7. Adjournment

Chair, REOC



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MINUTES OF THE MEETING

Panel Review/Regular/Special/Emergency Meeting

Date, Venue, Time

1. ATTENDANCE

Designation/Role	Name
Panel Chair	
Panel member	
Panel member	
Non-affiliated member	
Non-scientist member	
Panel Secretary	

2. CALL TO ORDER

<Title, First Name, Surname>, **Panel Chair**, called this regular meeting to order at <time> AM/PM.

3. DECLARATION OF QUORUM

4. REVIEW AND APPROVAL OF THE PROVISIONAL AGENDA

5. DISCLOSURE OF CONFLICT OF INTEREST

<Title, Surname of Panel Chair>, called for disclosure of Conflict of Interest (COI) in the Study Protocols scheduled for deliberation in the meeting. The following member/s inhibited from participation in the panel deliberations during the Panel Review meeting for the following reasons:

6. READING AND APPROVAL OF THE MINUTES OF THE LAST MEETING

6.1 Corrections in the Minutes

<Title, Surname of Panel Chair> presided over the discussion of the minutes of the **(WMSU Panel Review Meeting)** held last <dd/mm/yyyy> (**Date of last meeting**). The minutes were corrected during the discussion and approved as amended.

7. BUSINESS ARISING FROM THE MINUTES OF THE LAST MEETING

7.1. Matters requiring WMSU REOC action

8. STUDY PROTOCOL REVIEW

8.1. FULL REVIEW

8.1.1. Study Protocols for Initial Review

WMSU REOC Code		Assessment/ethics review/ICF
Study Protocol Submission Date		
Study Protocol Title		
Researcher		
Type of review		
Ethics Review Panel		
Primary Reviewers		
Sponsor		
Quorum status		
Conflict of interest		
Assessment of scientific soundness	1. Objectives/Expected output 2. Literature review 3. Research design 4. Sampling design, sample size 5. Inclusion criteria, exclusion criteria, withdrawal criteria 6. Research tools/methods 7. Statistical and data analysis plan 8. PI qualifications 9. Suitability and choice of site 10. Validation of research instruments among Filipino participants	
Assessment of ethical issues	1. Conflict of Interest: 2. Privacy and confidentiality including data protection plan 3. Vulnerability 4. Risks 5. Benefits 6. Recruitment process 7. Informed consent process 8. Documentation of collaborative study TOR	
Assessment of the Informed Consent Form (ICF)	1. Completeness of the elements of the ICF 2. Clarity of the ICF 3. Understandability of the ICF 4. Findings 5. Recommendations	
Conclusion and recommendations		
Action taken	Decision (Approval, Major Modification, which require full board deliberation, Minor Modification and concept approval(checkbox), which can be expedited at the level of the ERP Chair, Disapproval) *checkbox (Number of people who conformed with each decision)	
Reasons		

8.1.2. Resubmissions or Study Protocols for Modification

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Submission Date	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Type of Review	
Ethics Review Panel	
Reviewer/s	
Sponsor	
Quorum status	
Conflict of Interest	
Assessment of PI response to initial review program for recommendation	
Conclusion and recommendations	
Action taken	Decision (Approval, Major Modification, which require full board deliberation, Minor Modification, which can be expedited at the level of the ERP Chair, Disapproval)
Reasons	

8.1.3 Study Protocols for Clarificatory Interview

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Submission Date	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Type of Review	
Ethics Review Panel	
Sponsor	
Quorum status	
Conflict of Interest:	
Assessment of PI responses to Panel queries	
Conclusion and recommendations	
Action taken	Decision (Request action or information)
Reasons	

8.1.4. Withdrawal of Study Protocol Applications:

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Submission Date	
Withdrawal Application Date	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Type of Review	
Ethics Review Panel	
Sponsor	
Quorum status	
Conflict of Interest:	
Assessment of reasons for Study Protocol withdrawal	
Conclusion and recommendations	
Action taken	Decision (Approval, Request action or information)
Reasons	

8.1.5 Study Protocol Amendment Applications

WMSU REOC Code			
Study Protocol Approval Date			
Amendment Submission Date			
Study Protocol Title			
Researcher			
Type of Review			
Ethics Review Panel			
Sponsor			
Quorum status			
Conflict of Interest:			
Assessment of amendment requested	description of the amendment	justification of the amendment	assessment of the reviewer
Conclusion and recommendations			
Action taken	Decision (Approval, Minor modification to the proposed amendment, citing reasons for action, subject to expedited review at the level of the ERP Chair, Major modification to the proposed amendment, stating reasons for action, subject to full board review, Disapproval)		
Reasons			

8.1.6 Continuing Review Applications

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Approval Date	
Application Date	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Type of Review	
Ethics Review Panel	
Sponsor	
Quorum status	
Conflict of Interest:	
Assessment of progress reported	
Conclusion and recommendations	
Action taken	Decision (Uphold original approval with no further action, Request information, Recommend further action)
Reasons	
Status of continuing review (see continuing review of PHREB)	

8.1.7 Final Reports

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Approval Date	
Report Date	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Type of Review	
Ethics Review Panel	
Sponsor	
Quorum status	
Conflict of Interest:	
Assessment of final report	
Conclusion and recommendations	
Action taken	Decision Points (Approve, Request information, Recommend further action)
Reasons	

8.1.8 Site Visit Reports (part of the agenda and parts of the meeting, pattern to protocol application report)

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Approval Date	
Site Visit Date	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Type of Review	
Ethics Review Panel	
Sponsor	
Quorum status	
Conflict of Interest:	
Assessment of Site Visit Report	
Conclusion and recommendations	
Action taken	Decision Points (Uphold original approval with no further action, Request information, Recommend further action)
Reasons	

8.1.9 Study Protocol Non-Compliance (Deviation or Violation) Reports

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Approval Date	
Report Date	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Type of Review	
Ethics Review Panel	
Sponsor	
Quorum status	
Conflict of Interest:	
Assessment of Non-Compliance Report	
Conclusion and recommendations	
Action taken	Decision (Uphold original approval with no further action, Request information, Recommend further action, Forward to SAE Subcommittee)
Reasons	

8.1.10 Early Study Termination Applications

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Approval Date	
Application Date	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Type of Review	
Ethics Review Panel	
Sponsor	
Quorum status	
Conflict of Interest:	
Assessment of risks from early termination	
Conclusion and recommendations	
Action taken	Decision (Approval, Request information, Recommend further action)
Reasons	

8.1.11 Queries or Complaints

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Approval Date	
Application Date	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Type of Review	
Ethics Review Panel	
Sponsor	
Quorum status	
Conflict of Interest:	
Assessment of query or complaint	
Conclusion and recommendations	
Action taken	Decision (Uphold original approval with no further action, Request information, Recommend further action)
Reasons	

8.2. REPORT OF PROTOCOL SUBMISSIONS FOR EXPEDITED REVIEW AND FULL PROTOCOLS WITH MODIFICATION EXPEDITED AT THE LEVEL OF THE CHAIR

8.2.1. Approved Protocols

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Approval Date	
Study Protocol Submission Date	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Ethics Review Panel	
Action taken	APPROVAL

8.2.2. Study Protocols for Initial Review

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Submission Date	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Type of Review	
Ethics Review Panel	
Sponsor	
Action taken	Decision (Approval, Major Modification, which require full board deliberation, Minor Modification, which can be expedited at the level of the ERP Chair, Disapproval)

8.2.3. Resubmissions (study protocols for modification)

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Submission Date	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Type of Review	
Ethics Review Panel	
Sponsor	
Action taken	Decision (Approval, Major Modification, which require full board deliberation, Minor Modification, which can be expedited at the level of the ERP Chair, Disapproval)

8.2.4. Study Protocol Amendments

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Approval Date	
Date of Amendment Submission	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Type of Review	
Ethics Review Panel	
Sponsor	
Action taken	Decision (Approval, Minor modification to the proposed amendment, citing reasons for action, subject to expedited review at the level of the ERP Chair, Major modification to the proposed amendment, stating reasons for action, subject to full board review, Disapproval)

8.2.5. Continuing Review Applications

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Approval Date	
Date of Report	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Type of Review	
Ethics Review Panel	
Sponsor	
Action taken	Decision (Uphold original approval with no further action, Request information, Recommend further action)

8.2.6. Final Reports

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Approval Date	
Date of Report	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Type of Review	
Ethics Review Panel	
Sponsor	
Action taken	Decision Points (Approval, Recommend further action)

8.2.7. Study Protocol Non-Compliance (Deviation or Violation) Reports

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Approval Date	
Date of Report	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Type of Review	
Ethics Review Panel	
Sponsor	
Action taken	Decision (Uphold original approval with no further action, Request information, Recommend further action, Forward to AE Subcommittee)

8.2.8. Early Study Termination Applications

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Approval Date	
Application Date	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Type of Review	
Ethics Review Panel	
Sponsor	
Action taken	Decision (Approval, Request information, Recommend further action)

8.2.9. Queries or Complaints

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Approval Date	
Application Date	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Type of Review	
Ethics Review Panel	
Sponsor	
Action taken	Decision (Uphold original approval with no further action, Request information, Recommend further action)

8.3. REPORT OF PROTOCOL SUBMISSIONS ON EXEMPT FROM REVIEW PROTOCOLS AT THE LEVEL OF THE CHAIR

8.1.1. Approved Protocols

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Approval Date	
Study Protocol Submission Date	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Type of Review	
Ethics Review Panel	
Sponsor	
Action taken	APPROVAL

8.1.2. Continuing Review Applications

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Approval Date	
Date of Report	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Type of Review	
Ethics Review Panel	
Sponsor	
Action taken	Decision (Uphold original approval with no further action, Request information, Recommend further action)

8.1.3. Final Reports

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Approval Date	
Date of Report	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Type of Review	
Ethics Review Panel	
Sponsor	
Action taken	Decision Points (Approval, Recommend further action)

8.1.4. Study Protocol Non-Compliance (Deviation or Violation) Reports

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Approval Date	
Date of Report	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Type of Review	
Ethics Review Panel	
Sponsor	
Action taken	Decision (Uphold original approval with no further action, Request information, Recommend further action, Forward to SAE Subcommittee)

8.1.5. Early Study Termination Applications

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Approval Date	
Application Date	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Type of Review	
Ethics Review Panel	
Sponsor	
Action taken	Decision (Approval, Request information, Recommend further action)

8.1.6. Queries or Complaints

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Approval Date	
Application Date	
Study Protocol Title	
Researcher	
Type of Review	
Ethics Review Panel	
Sponsor	
Action taken	Decision (Uphold original approval with no further action, Request information, Recommend further action)

9. OTHER MATTERS

10. ADJOURNMENT

Meeting was adjourned at **<time>**

Prepared by:	
DATE: _____	_____ REOC STAFF
Reviewed By:	
DATE: _____	_____ Panel Secretary
Approved by:	
DATE: _____	_____ REOC CHAIR



Western Mindanao State University
Research Extension Services and External Linkage
RESEARCH ETHICS OVERSIGHT COMMITTEE
Zamboanga City, 7000, Philippines
reoc@wmsu.edu.ph



QUERIES OR COMPLAINTS

INSTRUCTIONS: *This form can be accomplished by any WMSU REOC personnel who receive queries, complaints, or grievances pertaining to any study protocol under the responsibility of the WMSU REOC. Information reported in this form is processed as a protocol-related submission. This form should be printed in A4 size paper and duly signed by the personnel accomplishing this report.*

WMSU REOC CODE:		
STUDY PROTOCOL TITLE:		
APPROVAL DATE:		
RESEARCHER:		
Email:	Telephone:	Mobile:
STUDY SITE:		
STUDY SITE ADDRESS:		
SPONSOR/FUNDING AGENCY (if any):		
SPONSOR CONTACT PERSON:		
Email:	Telephone:	Mobile:
DATE RECEIVED:		
1. RECEIVED BY (WMSU REOC Secretariat):		
2. REQUEST DELIVERED THROUGH: 2.1. ☐ Telephone 2.2. ☐ Fax No 2.3. ☐ Mailed letter dated: 2.4. ☐ E-mail dated: 2.5. ☐ Walk-in (indicate date/time) 2.6. ☐ Other, specify:		
3. PERSON LODGING THE QUERY OR COMPLAINT 3.1. <TITLE, NAME, SURNAME> 3.2. Address: <Street Number, Street, Barangay, City, Postal Code> 3.3. Telephone: <area code, number> 3.4. Mobile: <Provider code, number> 3.5. Email:		
4. CONNECTION/RELATION OF PERSON TO THE STUDY PROTOCOL 4.1. Study participant 4.2. Other <specify>		

5. PARTICIPANT CONCERNS

5.1. ☐ Query (**specify**)

5.2. ☐ Complaint (**specify**)

5.3. ☐ Others (**specify**)

6. REFERRED TO

6.1. ☐ Full Review by ERP

6.2. ☐ Expedited Review at the level of the ERP Chair

6.3. ☐ Exempt Review

7. Signature of WMSU REOC Secretariat:

RECOMMENDED ACTION (For WMSUREOC use only)

☐ UPHOLD ORIGINAL APPROVAL WITH NO FURTHER ACTION

☐ REQUEST INFORMATION: (**specify**)

☐ RECOMMEND FURTHER ACTION: (**specify**)

ETHICS REVIEW PANEL CHAIR	Signature
----------------------------------	-----------

Date:	Name
-------	------

REOC CHAIR	Signature
-------------------	-----------

Date:	Name
-------	------



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DOCUMENT HISTORY

Version No.	Date	Authors	Main Changes
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			



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SOP TEMPLATE

Logo of Institution	TITLE (which is descriptive of contents)	SOP No.	
		Version	
		Date of Effectivity	

- Statement of Policy**
- Objective of the activity** *(which defines the purpose and intended outcome)*
- Scope** *(which defines the extent of coverage of the SOP and its limitations)*
- Workflow** *(provides a graphic representation of the essential steps to implement the SOP and the responsible person for each step)*

Below are the different activities involved in the process of _____ and the responsible person/s in each of the activity.

Step No.	Activity	Responsible Person
1		
2		
3		
4		

- Description of Procedures** *(which elaborates the steps listed in workflow)*

Step 1 -

- Forms** *(documents to be accomplished by different parties as required by the SOP)*
Form ##

- History of the Standard Operating Procedure** *(tabulates the different versions (from draft to final versions) of the document by version, date, author, and description of main changes)*

Version No.	Date	Authors	Main Change
1			
2			



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APPOINTMENT LETTER FOR REGULAR MEMBER

Date

(Name of Regular Member)
(College/Dept.)
(Address)

Dear _____:

This is to inform you that you have been appointed to be an Ethics Review Panel of the Research Proposal entitled “_____” with **WMSU REOC Code:** _____, and categorized as Exempt/Expedited/Full review. The primary function of the reviewer is to perform an ethical review of research proposals and make appropriate recommendations and actions to ensure the safety of human participants recruited by the study. As a Regular Member, your responsibilities are as follows:

- a. Responsible for reviewing research protocols of the institutionally funded, graduates and undergraduates.
- b. Participates actively in SOPs development, review and recommends appropriate amendments and review of the progress report and final reports.
- c. Conducts site visits and similar activities of reviewed protocol as needed.
- d. Declares any conflict of interest in general and for specific research for review

Please signify your confirmation by signing in the space provided below, date your signature, and return one copy of this letter to the REOC Secretariat. If you have any questions you may visit the REOC Office and look for the Secretariat for assistance or you may call this mobile number _____.

Thank you and best regards.

Very truly yours,

REOC Chair

CONFORME (Regular Member)

Date: _____



Western Mindanao State University
Research Extension Services and External Linkage
RESEARCH ETHICS OVERSIGHT COMMITTEE
Zamboanga City, 7000, Philippines
reoc@wmsu.edu.ph



CLARIFICATORY CONFERENCE

Date

<Name of Researcher>

<Institution/Affiliation>

<Address>

Dear _____:

We wish to inform you that the **Western Mindanao State University Research Ethics Oversight Committee (WMSU REOC)** reviewed your research proposal entitled: _____ with WMSU REOC Code: _____ during its regular meeting on <**Date of Panel Meeting**>.

Upon review, the Ethics Review Panel found issues requiring clarifications such as:

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

In this regard, the Ethics Review Panel requests for a clarificatory conference with you on _____ <Date of Next meeting> from <requested time> at the <venue>.

Should you have any questions or clarifications regarding the above mentioned recommendations, please contact the undersigned through the **WMSU REOC** Secretariat at _____ or _____.

The **Ethics Review Panel** looks forward to your immediate response and action.

Very truly yours,

REOC Chair



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PROTOCOL SUBMISSION LETTER

_____ (Date)

_____ (Name of Researcher)

_____ (Address)

Dear _____,

This is to respectfully inform you that the Ethics Review Panel submitted their summary of findings and recommendations on the expedited ethics review evaluation on your research proposal entitled “_____” with WMSU REOC Code: _____. Attached herewith is the summary of findings and recommendations.

Please note that the cut-off date for submission of revised study protocol is on _____. Resubmissions of protocol can only be accepted **within 15 working days** from the date of this letter. Failure to respond within 15 days from the date of this letter will inactivate the application and study protocol will be archived. Subsequent submissions will be processed as initial review. Should you have any questions or clarifications regarding the abovementioned recommendations, please contact the undersigned through the WMSU REOC Secretariat at _____.

We are looking forward to receive your revised copy of the research protocol as soon as possible for the immediate issuance of the Research Ethics Clearance.

Very truly yours,

REOC Chair



Western Mindanao State University
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Zamboanga City, 7000, Philippines
reoc@wmsu.edu.ph



RESUBMISSION OF THE REVISED PROTOCOL LETTER FOR ERP

Date

<Name of Ethics Review Panel>

<College/Department.>

<Address>

Dear _____:

The REOC Office would like to inform you that the Researcher _____ submitted a copy of revised research proposal entitled _____ **with WMSU REOC Code:** _____ *for research ethics review*. The schedule of the meeting will be on _____, at _____, at the _____.

Attached is a copy of the study protocol.

For your attention and compliance.

Very truly yours,

REOC Chair



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reoc@wmsu.edu.ph



APPROVAL LETTER

Date

Researcher

Dear _____,

Greetings!

This is to inform you that REOC has recently reviewed your responses to the conditions placed upon the ethical approval for the project outlined below. Your research study protocol is now deemed to meet the requirements of the updated health-related ethical guidelines and approval for the issuance of Research Ethics Clearance has been granted.

Details of the approval are as follows:

WMSU REOC Code	
Study Protocol Title	
Approval Period	
Expiry date	
Researcher	
Version No.	

The standard conditions of this approval are:

1. Conduct the project strictly in accordance with the proposal submitted and granted ethics approval, including any amendments made to the proposal required by the REOC.
2. Advise (email: _____) immediately of any complaints or other issues (*Protocol deviations/violations, SAEs/SUSARs/RNEs*) in relation to the project which may warrant review of the ethical approval of the project.
3. Make submission for approval of amendments to the approved project before implementing such changes.
4. Provide a progress report for every (monthly/quarterly/mid-study) of approval
5. Provide a final report when the project is complete.
6. Advise in writing if the project has been discontinued.

Attached is the Research Ethics Clearance.

Very truly yours,

REOC Chair



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Zamboanga City, 7000, Philippines
reoc@wmsu.edu.ph



REMINDER LETTER FOR FINAL REPORT

Date

<Name of Researcher>

<Institution/Affiliation>

<Address>

Dear _____:

This is to remind you that the progress/final report for the study protocol entitled _____ with **WMSU REOC Code:** _____ had been due since _____. Based on the records of the **REOC**, there had been no communication regarding the progress of this study, which is still in our active file and has an active ethical clearance. Kindly inform REOC Office if the study had been concluded or terminated.

Kindly submit the progress report/final report form within fifteen (15) days of receiving this letter. If no submission is received within the indicated grace period, the committee will be constrained to implement standard procedures for non-compliance with reportorial requirements. This may result in a recommendation for withdrawal of ethical clearance; and the study file subsequently inactivated and archived.

Should you have any questions or clarifications regarding the abovementioned recommendations, please contact the undersigned through the **REOC** Secretariat at _____.

The **REOC** looks forward to your immediate response and action.

Thank you.

Very truly yours,

REOC Chair



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REMINDER LETTER FOR CONTINUING REVIEW

Date

<Name of Researcher>

<Institution/Affiliation>

<Address>

Dear _____:

We wish to remind you that the ethical clearance for the study protocol _____ with **WMSU REOC Code:** _____ will expire on (expiration date of approval). Based on the records of the **WMSU REOC**, there had been no communication regarding the progress of this study, which is still in our active file. If the study had been concluded or terminated, kindly fill out a final report form, or if still ongoing, a continuing review form.

Kindly submit the relevant report/form within thirty (30) days of receiving this letter. If no submission is received within the indicated grace period, the committee will be constrained to implement standard procedures for non-compliance with reportorial requirements. This may result in a recommendation for withdrawal of ethical clearance; and the study file subsequently inactivated and archived.

Should you have any questions or clarifications regarding the abovementioned recommendations, please contact the undersigned through the **WMSU REOC** Secretariat at _____ or email us at wmsuresearchethics@gmail.com.

The **WMSU REOC** looks forward to your immediate response and action.

Thank you.

Very truly yours,

REOC Chair



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Zamboanga City, 7000, Philippines
reoc@wmsu.edu.ph



APPOINTMENT OF INDEPENDENT CONSULTANT TEMPLATE

Date

(Name of ERP Member)

(College/Dept.)

(Address)

Subject: Appointment as Independent Consultant

Dear **Name:**

You are hereby appointed as Independent Consultant of the Research Ethics Oversight Committee (REOC) effective (from) to (to). As member/ independent consultant, your responsibilities are as follows:

1. Attend REOC meeting when requested.
2. Participate in the review of research proposals and other related reports when requested.
3. Declare any conflict of interest (COI) in the review of research proposals.
4. Maintain confidentiality of the documents and deliberations of the REOC meetings.

We look forward to partnering with you in ensuring that all health researches conform to local, national, and international ethical principles and standards towards respect for the rights, well-being and dignity of persons.

Thank you for accepting the invitation to be the member / Independent Consultant of the Research Ethics Oversight Committee. Kindly signify your acceptance by signing the conforme below.

Very truly yours,

INSTITUTIONAL AUTHORITY

Conforme:

Name and signature of Appointee



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RESEARCH ETHICS OVERSIGHT COMMITTEE
Zamboanga City, 7000, Philippines
reoc@wmsu.edu.ph



grants

this

RESEARCH ETHICS CLEARANCE

to

Researcher

Research Title: _____

WMSU REOC Code: _____

The grant of this Research Ethics Clearance for Study Implementation mandates the researcher's adherence to the current WMSU REOC ethical processes and standards. It may be revoked anytime for any violations committed during the conduct of the study.

A Quarterly Progress Report must be submitted for continuing ethics review. This Research Ethics Clearance will expire on _____.

Issued this _____ day of _____, _____ at
Research Ethics Oversight Committee Office, Zamboanga City.

REOC Chair



Western Mindanao State University
Research Extension Services and External Linkage
RESEARCH ETHICS OVERSIGHT COMMITTEE
Zamboanga City, 7000, Philippines
reoc@wmsu.edu.ph



grants

this

CERTIFICATE OF EXEMPTION

to

Researcher

Research Title: _____

WMSU REOC Code: _____

This certifies that this protocol does not involve human participants or with no or minimal risk to human participants. Hence, this is an exemption for research ethics review. The study may proceed with implementation.

Any change in the protocol invalidates the certificate and will require a new application for review. Submission of final report is required.

Issued this _____ day of _____, at Research Ethics Oversight Committee Office, Western Mindanao State University, Zamboanga City, Philippines.

REOC Chair

Appendix A

References

University Code, Western Mindanao State University

CIOMS International Ethical Guidelines for Biomedical Research Involving Human Subjects 2016

WHO Standards and Operational Guidance for Ethics Review of Health-Related Research with Human Participants 2011

Philippine Health Research Ethics Board Standard Operating Procedures 2020

National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants 2022

ISO 9001:2015 Quality Manual

Western Mindanao State University Research Manual

Appendix B

Glossary

Active Study is an ongoing study, implementation of which is within the period covered by ethics clearance.

Adjournment is the formal closure of the meeting. Motion for adjournment and record of the time are minuted.

Administrative Documents are documents that pertain to the operations of the REOC and are not directly related to a study or protocol. Examples include the SOPs, Membership files, Agenda and minutes files, administrative issuances.

Administrative Issuance is an official communications or announcements from institutional authorities.

After-approval reports are reports, e.g. progress report, protocol deviation/violation report, amendment, early termination report, final report, application for continuing review, required by the REOC for submission by the researcher/investigator after the study has been approved for implementation.

Agenda is the list of topics or items to be taken up in a meeting arranged in a sequential manner. It is an outline of the meeting procedure and starts with a "Call to Order".

Alternate Members are individuals who possess qualifications of specified regular members. They are called to attend a meeting and substitute for regular members to comply with the quorum requirement when the latter cannot attend the meeting.

Amendments any change or revision in the protocol made after its approval.

Appeal is a request of a researcher/ investigator for a reconsideration of the REOC recommendation.

Archiving is the systematic keeping of protocol files in storage after the studies have been completed with final reports accepted, or terminated or declared inactive.

Assessment Form is the evaluation tool accomplished by the reviewers when appraising the protocol or the informed consent form.

Benefits is a summary of probable positive or favorable outcomes ranging from benefit to the community (or society), indirect gains such as education, or direct therapeutic value

Businesses arising from the Minutes are the matters generated from the discussions in the previous meeting that need continuing attention and require reporting.

Clarification letter is a letter and any schedules or attachments thereto issued by the Authority to a Tenderer or Proponent summarizing all the clarified terms on which the Authority may issue a Letter of Acceptance to that Tenderer or Proponent and includes all modifications, amendments and supplements thereto.

Clarificatory Interview/meeting is a meeting or consultation of the REOC with the researcher for the purpose of obtaining explanations or clarity regarding some research issues identified by the REOC.

Coding is a unique number assigned to a protocol indicating the year and series it was received.

Competent Authority is designated officer or member of the REOC with the authority to respond to queries and complaints regarding studies approved by the REOC.

Complaint is the act of expressing discontent or unease about certain events or arrangements in connection with a study.

Confidentiality is the duty to not freely disclose private/research – information entrusted to an individual or organization.

Confidentiality of Documents pertains to the recognition and awareness that certain documents that have been entrusted or submitted to the REOC must not be freely shared or disclosed.

Conflict of Interest a situation in which the aims or concerns of two (primary and secondary) different interests are not compatible such that decisions may adversely affect the official/primary duties.

Consensus is a collective agreement.

Continuing Review is the decision of the REOC to extend ethical clearance of a study beyond the initial period of effectivity based on an appreciation that the research is proceeding according to the approved protocol and there is reasonable expectation of its completion.

Controlled document pertains to the document that have been entrusted or submitted to the REOC that must not be freely shared or disclosed such that it is appropriately tagged and its distribution carefully tracked, monitored and appropriately recorded.

Date of Effectivity is the date when the guidelines shall be enforced.

Database is a structured/organized collection of information so that the data can easily be accessed, managed and updated. And a collection of information that is structured and organized so that this can easily be accessed, managed, interpreted, analyzed and updated. It is usually an electronic platform used for tracking and monitoring the implementation of a study.

Decision is the result of the deliberations of the REOC in the review of a protocol or other submissions.

Draft Meeting Agenda is the order of business that includes the list of topics or items recommended for discussion in a meeting. This is endorsed to the REOC Chair for his/her approval.

Early Termination refers to the decision of the researcher, principal investigator, the institution, or sponsor to end the implementation of a study before its completion. This is a decision made by the sponsor or a regulatory authority and/or recommended by the Data Safety Monitoring Board, researcher/investigator in consideration of participant safety, funding issues, protocol violations, and data integrity issues.

Ethics Review Panel are members of the REOC who are assigned to do an in-depth evaluation of research-related documents using technical and ethical criteria established by the committee.

Ethics Review Panel Chair is the head of the members of the Ethics Review panel who will lead the review process and render the final decision when ERP members have an equal vote.

Ethics Review Panel Member a member of the REOC assigned to do an in-depth evaluation of the research-related documents using technical and ethical criteria established by the committee.

Exemption from Review a decision made by the REOC Chair or designated member of the committee regarding a submitted study proposal based on criteria in the National Ethical Guidelines for Research Involving Human Participants NEGRHP 2022.

Exemption Report is a list of protocols submitted for review that were deemed not to require the conduct of either expedited or full review. This report is presented during a regular committee meeting or as required by the institutional authority.

Expedited Review is the ethical evaluation of a research proposal and other protocol-related documents, a resubmission and after-approval submissions, conducted by only 2-3 members of the committee without involvement of the whole committee.

Expedited Review Reports is an enumeration of protocols (including titles, code number, proponent, submission date, names of reviewers and decisions) that underwent expedited review for information of the REC members and for record viewers.

Expertise proficiency, skill or know-how possessed by experts in a certain academic or professional field.

Final Meeting Agenda is the order of business that includes the list of topics or items approved for discussion in a meeting by the REC Members in a regular or special meeting.

Final Meeting Minutes are proceedings of the meeting that have been approved by the REOC members.

Final Report/Close Out Reports is a summary of the outputs and outcomes (including documented risks and benefits) of the study upon its completion, as well as the status of all participants. The REOC requires the accomplishment of the Final Report form within a reasonable period after the end of the study.

Format is a general style or layout of the document

Full Review is the ethical evaluation of a research proposal and other protocol-related documents, a resubmission and after-approval submissions, conducted by the research ethics committee en banc, in the presence of a quorum, using established technical and ethical criteria.

High Risk Studies Research where harm or danger resulting from the study intervention is very likely for participants.

Incoming Communications are documents which are directed to and received at the REOC office.

Independent consultant resource person who are not member of the Research Ethics Oversight Committee, whose expertise is needed in the review of a research protocol/proposal and who may be invited to attend a committee meeting but are non-voting during the deliberations.

Inactive Study a study whose proponent has not communicated with the REOC with regard to issues pertaining to the approval or implementation of the study – within a period of time required by the REOC.

Initial Review is the ethical and technical review conducted on the initially-submitted study documents. It may be expedited or full.

Initial Submission a set of documents consisting of the full proposal and other study related documents needs to be submitted so that review can be conducted.

Lay person a community representative who reviews and gives inputs on the informed consent form and process. Their highest formal education is a bachelor's degree.

Logbook a real-time, chronological record of incoming protocols that includes the Date/Time of Receipt, Title of the Document, Name of the Proponent, Name and Signature of the Submitting Entity, Name and Signature of the Receiving Person and Action done.

Major Modification is a recommended revision of significant aspects/s of the study (e.g., study objectives, recruitment of participants, exclusion/inclusion criteria, collection of data statistical analysis, mitigation of risks, protection of vulnerability, etc.) that impact on potential risks/harms to participants and on the integrity of the research.

Meeting Minutes is the official narration and record of the proceedings of the assembly of REOC Members, based on the agenda.

Minimal Risk term used when the probability and magnitude of harm or discomfort anticipated in a research are not greater, in and of themselves, than those encountered in daily life or during the performance of routine physical or psychological examinations or tests.

Minor Modification is a recommended revision of particular aspect/s of the study or related documents that do not impact on potential risks/harms to participants and on the integrity of the research, e.g. incomplete documentation, incomplete IC elements, unsatisfactory IC format)

More than Minimal Risk is a term used when the probability and magnitude of harm or discomfort anticipated in a research are greater, in and of themselves, than those encountered in daily life or during the performance of routine physical or psychological examinations or tests.

Non-affiliated Member/s are regular members who are not in the roster of personnel or staff of the Institution. They are not employees of the institution, nor do they receive regular salary or stipend from the institution.

Non-Scientists are individuals, whose primary interest is not in any of the natural, physical, and social sciences and whose highest formal education is a bachelor's degree.

Outgoing Communications are documents generated within the REOC office intended for individuals or offices related to the operations of the REOC.

Operations-related Matters are items included in the agenda that are not directly related to any protocol under review.

Post-approval Reports are accounts of the ongoing implementation of an approved study (e.g., progress report, amendment, safety report, protocol deviation/violation, early termination, final report, or application for continuing review) that are required be submitted by the researcher to the REOC for monitoring purposes.

Primary Reviewers are members of the Research Ethics Oversight Committee (usually a scientist and a non-scientist) assigned to do an in-depth evaluation of the research related documents using technical and ethical criteria established by the committee and shall present their findings and recommendations during the meeting for discussion.

Progress Report is a description of how the implementation of the study is moving forward. This is done by accomplishing the FR-012-Application for Ethics Review of Progress Report. The frequency of submission (e.g., quarterly, semi-annually or annually) is determined by the REOC based on the level of risk.

Protocol refers to the research or study proposal and documentation of the study proposal that includes a presentation of the rationale and significance of the study, background and review of literature, study objectives, study design and methodology, data collection, dummy tables, plan for analysis of data, ethical consideration, and dissemination plan.

Protocol Database is the significant information about protocols that are organized systematically so that these can easily be accessed, managed, interpreted, analyzed and updated. It is usually an electronic platform used for tracking and monitoring the implementation of a study.

Protocol Deviation non-compliance with the approved protocol that does not increase risk or decrease benefit to participants or does not significantly affect their rights, safety or welfare or the integrity of data. Example: missed visit, non-submission of a food diary on time.

Protocol Violation is non-compliance with the approved protocol that may result in an increased risk or decreased benefit to participants or significantly affect their rights, safety or welfare or the integrity of data. Example: incorrect treatment, non-compliance with inclusion/exclusion criteria.

Protocol File is an organized physical or electronic compilation of all documents related to a Protocol.

Protocols for Full Review are the study proposals that require an en banc ethical assessment because they entail more than minimal risks to the participants and/or that participation generates vulnerability issues.

Protocol Index is a chronological record of the documents in the protocol file. The protocol index is in table form indicating the date of filing, the nature of the document filed the name and signature of the person who filed and an extra column to record any movement of the document. The index is pasted inside the cover page of the protocol file/folder for easy reference and checking

Protocol Violation non-compliance with the approved protocol that increases risk or decreases benefit to participants or significantly affects their rights, safety or welfare or the integrity of data. Example: incorrect treatment, non-compliance with inclusion/exclusion criteria.

Protocol-related Documents consist of all other documents aside from the proposal/protocol itself that are required to be submitted for review, e.g., Informed Consent Form, Survey Questionnaire, CV of proponent, advertisements, In-depth Interview Guide Questions.

Protocol-related submissions other documents that are included (required) in the submission of the protocol, e.g., Informed Consent Forms, study tools (Interview guide, survey questionnaire, FGD guide) and CVs of the proponents and certificates of training.

Provisional Meeting Agenda is the order of business that includes the list of topics or items approved for discussion in a meeting by the REC Chair.

Provisional Meeting Minutes are the proceedings of the meeting that have been noted or approved by the Presiding officer.

Query is the act of asking for information or clarification about a study.

Quorum is the presence of the majority of the REOC members including the non-affiliated and the non-scientist members. And also the minimum number (i.e., majority of the members) and type of members of the REOC are required to be present in any meeting for the proceedings to be considered valid. International and national guidelines require the presence of at least 5 regular members including the non-affiliated and the non-scientist members.

Real-time Recording is the process of documenting the minutes of the meeting as the meeting proceeds simultaneously.

Researcher is the individual primarily responsible for the conceptualization, planning and implementation of a study.

Resubmissions revised study proposals that are submitted after the initial review.

Regular Meeting a periodically scheduled assembly of the REOC.

Regular Members are members constituting the research ethics committee, who receive official appointments from the institutional authority with specific terms and responsibilities including review of research proposals and attendance of meetings.

Reportable Negative Events (RNE) are occurrences in the study site that indicate risks or actual harms to participants and to members of the research team and to integrity of data. Examples are brewing hostilities in the research community, natural calamities, unleashed dogs, threats of harassment, etc.

Risks is a summary of probable negative or unfavorable outcomes ranging from inconvenience, discomfort, or physical harm based on the protocol

Scientific but non-affiliated person are individuals whose formal education is at least a master's degree in a scientific discipline (e.g., biology, physics, social science, etc.). They are not an employee of Western Mindanao State University (WMSU).

Scientists are individuals whose formal education is at least a master's degree in a scientific discipline (e.g., biology, physics, and social science).

Site Visit is an activity of the REOC where an assigned team goes to the research site or office for specific monitoring purposes.

Site Visiting Team are members/staff of the REOC (2-4 members) assigned by the REOC Chair to formally go to the research site, meet with the research team and evaluate compliance with the approved protocol and Informed Consent Form and Process, including other related research procedures to ensure promotion of the rights, dignity and well-being of participants and protection of integrity of data.

Serious Adverse Event (SAE) Subcommittee is a group of individuals with the necessary expertise, assigned by the REOC to review SAEs and SUSARs and provide the pertinent recommendation for action of the REOC.

Special meeting an assembly of the Committee outside of the regular schedule of meetings for a specific purpose, usually to decide on an urgent matter like selection of officer, approval of a revised or new SOP, report of critical research problem that requires immediate action.

Sponsor is an individual, company, institution or organization which takes responsibility for the initiation, management, and financing of a clinical trial.

Sponsored-Clinical Trials are a systematic study on pharmaceutical products in human subjects (including research participants and other volunteers), whose conceptualization, protocol development and support for their conduct are the responsibilities of sponsors who manufactured the products, in compliance with the requirements of regulatory authorities.

Standard Operating Procedures are the step-by-step description of the different procedures done to accomplish the objective of an activity. They consist of clear, unambiguous instructions for ethical review to ensure quality and consistency.

Status of participants is a summary of what happened to (condition of) participants recruited to the study, including those that completed the study, those that dropped out, or those withdrawn for specific reasons in accordance with the protocol.

Study Documents includes all materials (protocol, forms, certificates, research tools) pertinent to a research proposal that have to be submitted to the REOC for review.

Suspected Unexpected Serious Adverse Reactions (SUSAR) is a noxious response to a drug that is not described in the Investigator's Brochure or in the drug insert.

Termination package refers to the entitlements of study participants in the event of discontinuance of the study, which can come in the form of access to the study intervention, treatment, or information, for purposes of adherence to the principle of fairness for all concerned.

Voting is the act of expressing opinions or making choices usually by casting ballots, spoken word or hand-raising. The rule is majority wins.

Vulnerable Groups are participants or potential participants of a research study who may not have the full capacity to protect their interests and may be relatively or absolutely incapable of deciding for themselves whether or not to participate in the research. They may also be at a higher risk of being harmed or to be taken advantage.